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bl. portfolio



Technical analysis.
**How much more
can the BSE IT
index get beaten
down?**
BIG STORY P2



Simply put.
**Decoding crude's
spot realities vs
futures pricing
divergence**
SAFE INVESTING P9

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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Peak-cycle buybacks haunt India's IT giants

MISPLACED CHEER. Just seven months ago, the Infosys management had announced a ₹18,000-cr buyback at a price 56 per cent above current levels

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Infosys shares' 7 per cent fall on Friday to a five-year low was a fresh reminder that the market lacks confidence in any near-term turnaround for the Indian IT companies.

It also sends a clear message not just to the investors who thought IT stocks can't go much lower, but also to companies and managements intending to use buybacks as a signal to investors.

Just seven months ago, the Infosys management had announced a ₹18,000-crore buyback at a price 56 per cent above current levels, and that too at a time when buyback taxation was onerous.

That decision now appears quite ill-conceived.

Overall, current realities make the sector's post-Covid buybacks look like misleading signals for investors.

Buybacks are, after all, meant to signal that managements/boards view their shares as undervalued — a message that should

Poor signals

Company	Buyback board meeting/announcement date	Buyback amount (₹ cr)	Buyback price (₹)	Fall from buyback price (%)	Buyback price/earnings (trailing)	Current price/earnings (trailing)	Since buyback	
							Stock return (CAGR %)	Nifty 50 return (CAGR %)
TCS	11-Oct-23	17,000	4150	42	30x	18x	-19	8
TCS	12-Jan-22	18,000	4500	47	39x		-14	7
TCS	07-Oct-20	16,000	3000	20	34x		-4	14
Infosys	11-Sep-25	18,000	1800	36	23x	16x	-36	-4
Infosys	13-Oct-22	9,300	1850	38	26x		-12	10
Infosys	14-Apr-21	9,200	1750	34	30x		-8	10
Wipro	16-Apr-26	15,000	250	20	17x	16x	-20	-1
Wipro	27-Apr-23	12,000	222.5	10	18x		-4	10
Wipro	13-Oct-20	9,500	200	0	23x		0	13

Source: Bloomberg & bl.portfolio calculations; Numbers are rounded off Stock prices adjusted for split/bonus Stock returns measured from buyback price Below one year returns are absolute; others are CAGR

carry weight given their insider perspective.

Since Covid, the three IT services giants — TCS, Infosys and Wipro — have together announced deployment of about ₹1.24 lakh crore in buybacks. In most cases, the stocks now trade well below buyback prices.

The pitch was familiar — excess cash, strong confidence and shareholder-friendly capital allocation. The outcome looks less flattering.

Instead of marking undervaluation, many buybacks now look like markers of peak-cycle optimism.

While some of the pre-FY24 buybacks may have had an element of tax arbitrage, investors largely read them as value signals.

TALE OF 3 BEHEMOTHS

Start with sector giant TCS, often lauded for its disciplined execution. Announced between October 2020 and October 2023, it conducted three buybacks at ₹3,000, ₹4,500 and ₹4,150, at trailing P/E multiples of 34x, 39x and 30x respectively.

Today, the stock is around ₹2,400, trading at

about 18x earnings — implying shares were retired when valuations were roughly double current levels. The result? Investors who did not tender are staring at -20 per cent to -47 per cent drawdowns from buyback prices, with stock CAGRs of -4 per cent to -19 per cent.

Meanwhile, the supposedly boring Nifty 50 delivered 7-14 per cent CAGR over the same periods. Even the Nifty IT index did not see comparable drawdowns. So much for buybacks acting as a valuation floor.

Those who exited through the tender window captured the premium; those who stayed are now absorbing the reset.

Infosys offers a similar, if slightly subtler, lesson in multiple compression. Its buybacks came at ₹1,750, ₹1,850 and ₹1,800, with trailing P/Es of 30x, 26x and 23x. The stock now trades at about ₹1,155, or 16x earnings — 34-38 per cent below buyback prices.

Returns from those levels range from -8 per cent to -36 per cent. From the 2021-22 buyback announcements, the Nifty 50

delivered -10 per cent CAGR, while Infosys posted negative returns. Investors would have been better off buying the index than relying on "capital return discipline."

Wipro complicates the narrative, but does not overturn the trend. Its 2020 buyback at ₹200 looks benign in hindsight, with the stock roughly flat.

But the 2023 buyback at ₹222.5 is already 10 per cent underwater, and the 2026 announced buyback price at ₹250 is about 20 per cent away from the current price — hardly evidence of precise timing.

— these programmes look mistimed. Unfortunately, these buybacks were also cheered by many analysts.

So as with any case of irrational exuberance, what followed was predictable, if not forecasted. Growth moderated, discretionary tech spending slowed, and AI introduced a fresh layer of uncertainty into the services model.

The result was multiple compression from -30x to mid-teens and that did most of the damage.

There is also the question of opportunity cost. The ₹1.24 lakh crore spent on buybacks could have funded years of investment in AI capabilities, platforms, and acquisitions — areas where the sector is now scrambling to catch up.

Alternatively, at least returning it as dividends would have ensured the money reached all shareholders rather than benefiting only those who tendered.

For investors, the takeaway is clear: a buyback, especially at elevated valuations, is not a signal of undervaluation.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Jyothy Labs: Buy

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

The stock of Jyothy Labs, a mid-tier FMCG player, has corrected about 30 per cent over the past year to ₹259.50 after an earlier sharp run-up.

bl.portfolio had advised partial profit-booking in July 2024 (₹480) and shifted to accumulate in April 2025 (₹360).

The stock has since underperformed peers as growth slowed and valuations compressed.

However, early signs of stabilisation are visible, with improving volumes, recovery in key segments and better mix.

With a net-debt free balance-sheet and strengthening growth drivers, the risk-reward has turned favourable.

The stock trades at 24 times forward earnings, at a discount to historical averages.

We recommend that long-term investors buy with a three-to-five-year horizon.

Fast-evolving capital market needs sophisticated regulatory approach: FM

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday called for a more "sophisticated and anticipatory" regulatory approach to India's capital markets, urging Securities and Exchange Board of India to deepen investor trust while keeping pace with rapid technological and structural shifts.

Speaking at SEBI's 38th Foundation Day, Sitharaman pushed for simpler, standardised, digital KYC processes across financial sectors, asking the regulator to lead the effort towards a seamless investor experience.

She also called for a deeper corporate bond market, greater retail participation, and a stronger push for municipal bonds to finance urban

infrastructure. Noting that Indian markets have evolved into one of the world's most advanced ecosystems, she warned that rising scale and complexity require stronger surveillance, cybersecurity preparedness, and investor protection frameworks.

"The lesson that we must draw from history is not that regulation should become more restrictive, but that it should become more sophisticated and anticipatory rather than merely reactive," she said, emphasising that trust and integrity remain the "invisible infrastructure" of financial markets.

KEY MILESTONES

Highlighting SEBI's achievements, she cited India's early adoption of the T+1 settlement cycle, pioneering use of ASBA (application supported



Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

by blocked amount) for IPOs, and UPI-based applications, which have significantly broadened retail participation.

In FY26, primary markets saw a record 366 IPOs raising about ₹1.9 lakh crore, reflecting strong capital formation momentum, the Minister said. SEBI's success rate at legal forums — over 90 per cent in the

Supreme Court, 73 per cent at the Securities Appellate Tribunal, and 92 per cent at Civil Courts and NCLT — demonstrated the institutional strength of its legal architecture, she added.

However, the FM cautioned that increased retail participation must be matched with financial awareness. "Participation without understanding can create vulnerability," Sitharaman said, adding that investor protection should evolve from a defensive to a developmental function.

She also flagged risks from unregistered "fin-fluencers," deepfake-driven frauds, and AI-enabled cyberattacks, calling for stricter enforcement and greater public awareness. She asked SEBI to expand tools such as 'SEBI Check' and strengthen real-time monitoring.

TENUOUS TALKS



PEACE HUDDLE. Pakistan's Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif (right) meets with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi (black suit) in Islamabad on Saturday amid regional tensions and efforts by Pakistan to facilitate a second round of talks between the US and Iran. While a US delegation was to come, the Iranian team left Pakistan without waiting for the American envoys REUTERS

Moving to simplify rules, push tech-led oversight: SEBI chief

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The market regulator will step up effort to simplify regulations, deepen technology-led supervision, and support capital formation as domestic markets grow in scale and complexity, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey has said.

Speaking at the 38th Foundation Day of the Securities and Exchange Board of India, Pandey outlined a forward agenda focussed on easing compliance, strengthening governance, and aligning innovation with investor protection. The event was attended by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.

"We will accelerate our drive to simplify and rationalise regulations for ease of doing business... and continue to invest in technology-led



Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman of SEBI

supervision," Pandey said. Indian markets have expanded sharply in size and participation, with over 5,900 listed companies and more than 140 million investors, he said.

PARTICIPATION UP

Market capitalisation has grown at about 15 per cent annually over the past decade, while mutual fund assets have risen over 20 per cent a year.

"The deeper shift is in participation," he said, pointing to the rise of a younger, digitally connected investor base and stronger global linkages. This expansion, he cautioned, brings new risks. "Innovation must not outpace safeguards; access must not dilute awareness; and growth must remain sustainable."

Over the past year, SEBI has worked to ease regulatory friction and improve clarity through stakeholder consultations. "These reforms are not isolated steps... they are part of a continuous effort to build trust, efficiency and innovation into the market," Pandey said.

He added that new systems — including digital communication platforms and an e-adjudication mechanism — alongside greater use of data analytics, AI tools, and real-time monitoring, will strengthen oversight.

Vikram-1 nose cone heads to Sriharikota launch pad

Skyroot Aerospace eyes India's first private orbital mission later this year

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

A 2.5-m-long, 1.3-m-wide bullet-shaped nose cone of Vikram-1 has begun its journey from Skyroot Aerospace's Hyderabad facility to the Satish Dhawan Space Centre, signalling a pivotal moment for India's private space ambitions.

The start-up aims to launch the 23-m rocket in the coming months, subject to final clearances. The mission will mark India's first private orbital launch attempt, positioning Skyroot in a global market dominated by a handful of players.

The multi-stage vehicle can deploy small satellites of up to 350 kg in low Earth orbit. Built with an all-carbon



LAUNCH PREP. The bullet-shaped nose part of Vikram-1 rocket being flagged off from Skyroot Aerospace manufacturing facility in Hyderabad on Saturday KV KURMANATH

composite structure, it features high-thrust solid boosters and advanced propulsion systems, including a 3D-printed engine.

"The heart of the rocket, the propulsion system that will power the rocket, has

already reached the space centre. The brain and the rest of the body of the rocket will reach the centre over the next week," Pavan Kumar Chandana, Co-Founder and CEO of Skyroot, told businessline.

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy flagged off the transport of the nose cone on Saturday, marking the completion of pre-flight testing at Skyroot's facilities.

As the nose cone heads to Sriharikota, the remaining three-stage shells are set to follow. Named after APJ Abdul Kalam, the stages will deliver payloads to orbit with high thrust.

SMALL TEST PAYLOADS

However, the maiden flight will carry only a small payload. "We will test the systems in 2-3 launches before making the rockets fully ready for their optimum payload level of 300 kg each. In a year, we would like to launch one rocket every

month," Chandana said.

Backed by \$100 million in funding over four years, the start-up is targeting a share of the \$600-billion global launch market and may raise additional capital to fuel expansion. It currently employs over 1,000 people.

"We completed the most critical testing of Vikram-1 and are excited to begin integration and launch campaign activities next week at the spaceport towards this historic launch," said Naga Bharath Daka, Co-founder and COO, Skyroot Aerospace.

The upcoming mission is the first of several planned Vikram-1 launches, aimed at enabling regular commercial launch services for satellite operators worldwide.

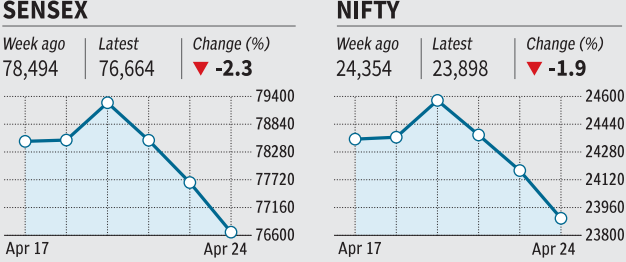
bl.portfolio

WISE WORDS.

“The habit of relating what is paid to what is being offered is an invaluable trait in investment. Operations for profit should be based not on optimism but on arithmetic.”

BENJAMIN GRAHAM
Father of value investing

MARKET ACTION.



Charting the direction of IT index

TECHNICAL ANALYSIS. The BSE Information Technology (IT) index is down about 25 per cent (year-to-date) and is the worst performing sector so far. It is also down 40 per cent from all-time highs. Is it time to do bottom fishing or can it fall more? Here’s what the charts reveal



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Information Technology (IT) stocks have been beaten down badly this year. The BSE Information Technology (IT) index, down about 25 per cent (year-to-date) is the worst performing sector so far. The index declined 15 per cent last year as well and was the second worst performer. From the peak of 45,792 made in December 2024, the index is down about 40 per cent.

In our Big Story, “Sectors to play in 2026”, written in January this year, we had given a buy in the BSE IT index. The index was then at 36,795 and we had forecast for a rally to 49,500 by the end of this year. This view has gone wrong. The BSE IT index hit our stop-loss level of 30,600 and tumbled well beyond to touch a low of 27,428 last month. It is currently trading at 27,648.74.

Can the IT index fall more? If yes, how far can it fall? Where can the index find its bottom? As an investor, is this the right time to do a bottom fishing or should you wait for some more time? Here is our take based on technical analysis.

ON THE CHARTS

There is no concrete sign of either a bottom or a trend reversal visible on the charts currently. However, there are some strong supports coming up for the index. The first one is at 26,930, which is the 100-Month Moving Average (MMA). This will be an important support to watch. Because during the Covid market crash, the IT index found a bottom just above this 100-MMA.

The second important support is in the 24,700-24,250 region. A trendline and the 61.8 per cent Fibonacci Retracement support are poised in this region.

Resistances are at 36,000 and then in the 39,500-40,000 region.

We are now going to discuss two possible scenarios here.

Firstly, we have to see if the IT Index sustains above 26,930 (100-MMA) itself and then goes above 36,000 or not. If it does, then that could be an initial sign of relief and an early indication of a trend reversal.

Second scenario will be if the index breaks below the 100-MMA support (26,930). In this case, there can be an extended fall to 24,700 or 24,250. For now, we do not expect a fall beyond 24,250. There are good chances for the BSE IT index to find a bottom in the 24,700-24,250. This will be another 12 per cent from the current levels.

A strong bounce from the 24,700-24,250 support zone and a subsequent rise above 30,000 will give a breather. Thereafter, a rise above 36,000 will give early signs of a trend reversal.

In both the scenarios, 39,500-40,000 is going to be a very crucial

level to watch. Ideally, the BSE IT index has to rise above 40,000 to confirm a trend reversal and become convincingly bullish. Only then will the doors open for a fresh rally to 52,000-53,000 over the long term, that is over the next two years or so.

So, as seen from the charts, it looks like a wait-and-watch situation for now.

LOG’S A DIFFERENT PICTURE

The picture on the log chart is pretty clear. The BSE IT index is now at a strong long-term support if we look at the log chart. Before we get into the details, let us first see what a log chart is. Then we will see how significant it is to use it in technical analysis.

So, here we try to explain what a log chart captures in simple terms.

In a normal chart, the absolute value will be captured as it is. For example, assume that the BSE IT index moves from 100 to 200 in January and then from 200 to 400 in February.

On the candle chart, the size of the January candle will be 100 points (100 to 200) and that of February will be 200 points (200 to 400).

That is the size of the February candle (200 points) will be double that of the January candle (100 points).

The log chart, on the other hand, captures the percentage change between two points rather than the absolute values. If we take the same example given above, the movement between 100 and 200 in January and 200 and 400 in February, both will be a 100 per cent move. So, if we plot a candle for these two months, then both will be of the same size in a log chart.

USE OF LOG CHART

In technical analysis, the log charts are used for analysing long historical data. It helps to identify the long-term trend and make forecasts. Many a time, the log chart helps identify crucial supports and resistances, and also major reversal points, which cannot be spotted on the normal absolute price chart.

Any unexpected high volatility in the market caused due to a natural disaster (Covid) or geopolitical tensions are normalised when a log chart is used.

In technical analysis, we use log chart in conjunction with the absolute chart to get better clarity when the latter does not give you a clear picture.

BSE IT index – Log chart analysis

The outlook for the BSE IT index is strongly bullish, if we look at its log

chart. There is a long-term trendline support at 27,400. Another support is 26,650. In addition to this, the price action since 2008 indicates a bull channel. The index is now hovering above the lower end of this channel. So, from a long-term perspective, there are good chances for the BSE IT index to go up towards the upper end of this channel in the coming years.

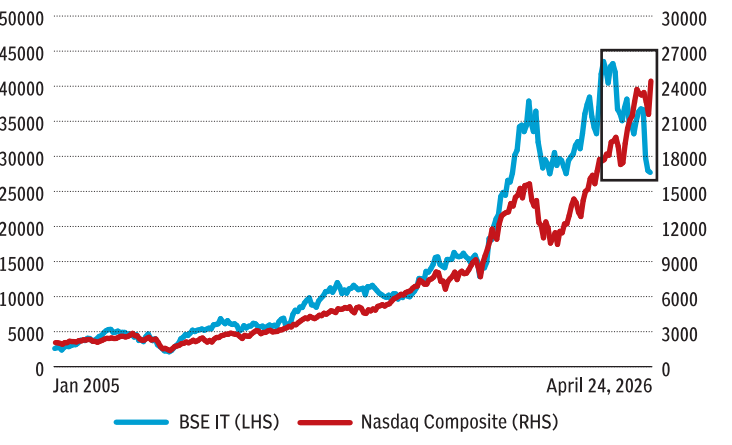
But given the current scenario, such a strong rise may look unlikely, considering the fundamental factors especially given the AI disruption. But based on the log chart, such a rise is a possibility.

Given the current negative sentiment, one possible scenario could be that, the BSE IT index may run into a sideways range for some time. The trading range could be 26,500-40,000. Once the fundamental situation improves, then maybe the index can make a bullish breakout above 40,000 and go up towards 53,000 first and then to the upper end of the channel in the coming years.

INTERESTING OBSERVATION

The BSE IT index movement from 2009 to 2011 and 2020 to 2022, shows an interesting pattern. The index bottomed at a low of 1,987.81 in February 2009 and then surged to a high

Diverging times



of 6,921.41 in January 2011.

Similarly, from the bottom of 10,937 (March 2020), the index peaked at 38,713 (January 2022). This is about 250 per cent surge happened in about 22-23 months.

This year in March, the index touched a low of 27,428 and is attempting to bounce. If the same pattern that was seen earlier has to repeat, then the index can see a peak in January 2028. But the question is whether a 250 per cent surge is possible. The answer could be NO, given the current fundamental background.

However, if one has to go purely by the charts, then that possibility cannot be ruled out. So, we may have to keep an eye on this.

DIVERGENCE

The BSE IT and the NASDAQ Composite have always moved in tandem. But there has been some divergence since 2025. The NASDAQ Composite index has surged 29 per cent since December 2024.

The BSE IT index tumbled 36 per cent over the same period.

The NASDAQ Composite (24,837) index looks bullish for a rise to 27,000-27,500 in the coming months. If the current divergence between the two indices continue to exist, then the rise in NASDAQ Composite index may not aid the BSE IT index to rise back. Conversely, if both start to move together again, then it can help the BSE IT index to revive.

We will have to wait and watch.

CONCLUSION

Combining all the factors discussed above, there is no concrete evidence that the BSE IT index has already bottomed out.

The absolute chart indicates that there is another 8-12 per cent downside left from here. However, on the log chart, the index is already close to long-term support. So, we suggest investors enter this index in a staggered manner.

INVESTING STRATEGY

Investors can consider investing 20 per cent of the intended capital at

current levels. Buy another 30 per cent at 26,800. The balance of 50 per cent can be invested when the BSE IT index falls to 25,600.

The average entry in this case will be 26,370. Keep the stop-loss at 20,800. Trail the stop-loss up to 28,800 when the index goes up to 33,300. Revise the stop-loss higher to 34,600, 42,300 and 47,500 when the index goes up to 38,800, 45,600 and 49,800 respectively. Exit the trade and book profits when the index goes up to 51,500.

Now, what if the index reverses higher from around 26,500 itself and does not fall to 24,700-24,250. One will miss out on the third entry level of 25,600.

In this case, investors will have to be ready to buy more at higher levels. The third entry can be split at 20 per cent at 32,300 and 30 per cent at 37,800. In this scenario, the average entry level will be 31,370. The stop-loss, target and other strategies can be the same as was mentioned in the previous case.

INVESTMENT OPTIONS

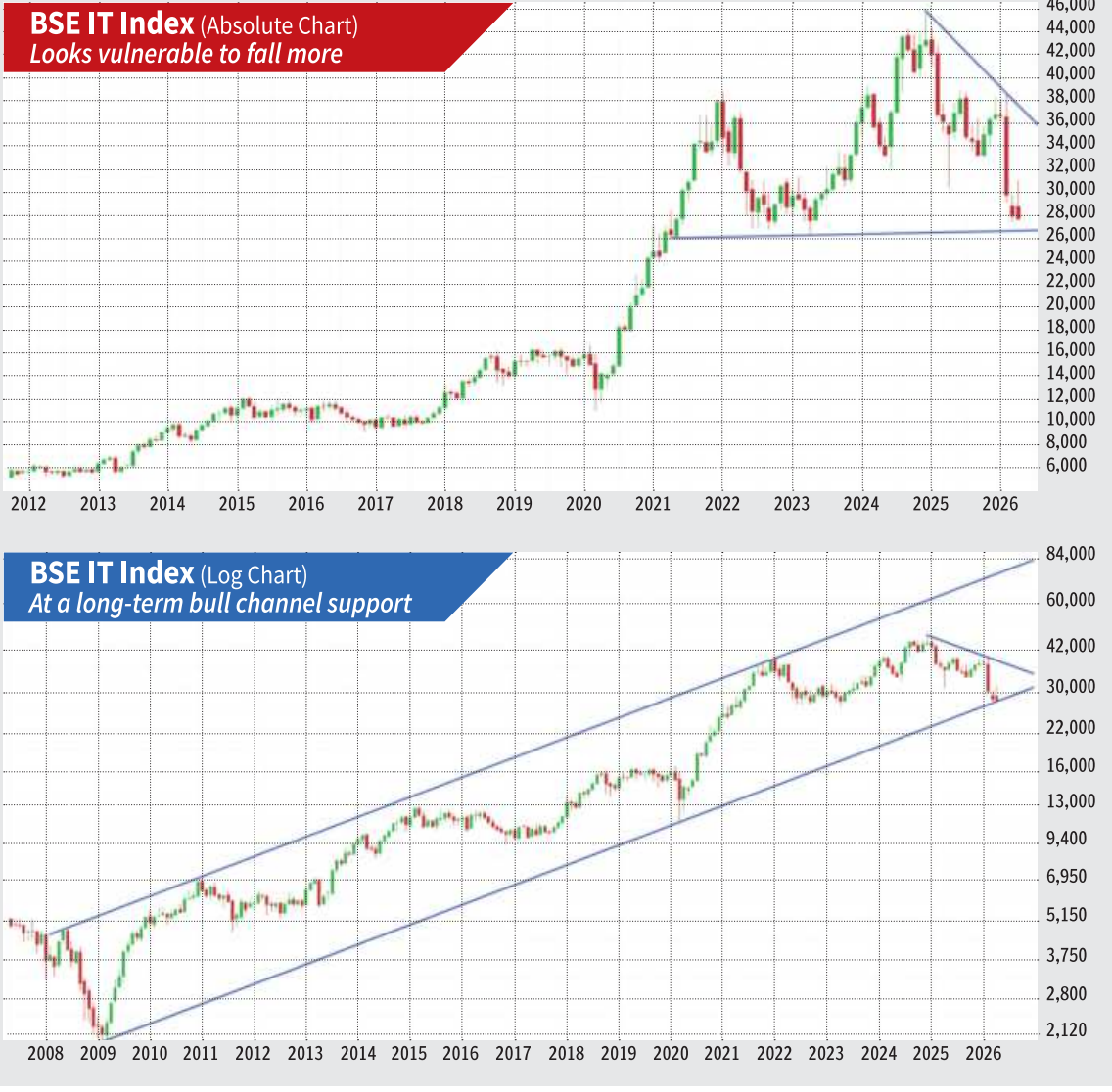
On the charts, the individual stocks and bellwethers like TCS, Infosys, HCL Technologies and Wipro are not giving a clear picture to take a convincing investment decision. So, we suggest investors go for other alternate instruments that are available in the market.

There are many direct mutual fund (index funds) schemes and exchange-traded funds for investors who wish to consider investing in the IT sector. Among the ETFs, Nippon India ETF Nifty IT, ICICI Prudential Nifty IT ETF and Kotak Nifty IT ETF can be considered.

Those looking for direct mutual fund schemes can look for ICICI Prudential Nifty IT Index Fund, Nippon India Nifty IT Index Fund and Axis Nifty IT Index Fund.

The levels mentioned in the investment strategy above can be considered as a proxy for entry and exit from mutual funds or ETF.

There is always a risk of the forecast going wrong. So, strictly adhering to the stop-loss is a must.



Decoding MF flows data

REAL RETURNS. Data from the Association of Mutual Funds of India show five useful trends for your investing decisions

Aarati Krishnan

Foreign investors have been actively fleeing Indian equities for two years now. But Indian indices have still proved resilient to events such as the India-Pakistan conflict, Iran war and the resulting oil shock.

It is domestic institutions, now sitting on 18.3 per cent of listed shares by value (compared to 16.7 per cent for FPIs) that have been absorbing bouts of manic selling by FPIs. Their actions are, in turn, decided by retail investor behaviour.

So, in March, as war clouds gathered, oil prices shot past \$100 and the rupee slid 4 per cent, how did Indian mutual fund investors behave? Data on MF flows from the Association of Mutual Funds of India (AMFI) show five trends which are useful for your investing decisions.

PULLOUTS DID SPIKE

When markets fall, the first instinct of a newbie investor is to panic and sell her equity holdings. This did happen in March 2026. As the Nifty50 fell 11 per cent in March, open-end equity MFs saw their redemption demands spike 20 per cent to ₹43,325 crore in March from ₹36,098 crore in February. This number was also 37 per cent higher than the year-ago number of ₹31,443 crore in March 2025.

The higher redemption demands likely came from two sets of investors. Investors who joined the equity bandwagon in the last five years post-Covid, who have enjoyed big equity gains with very little volatility. Seasoned investors looking to save on capital gains tax by 'harvesting' losses before the March 31 deadline. It is hard to say which cohort made up the bigger number.

However, it is likely that newer investors made up the bulk. The MF industry's equity accounts have shot up from 6.26 crore in March 2020 to 18.27 crore in March 2026. This suggests that two-thirds of the current crop of equity MF accounts are held by post-Covid newbie investors. These investors probably accounted for a larger proportion of the redemption numbers.



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- FPIs fleeing equities, DIIs absorb selling
- Redemptions spiked, but inflows rose higher
- SIP closures surged, but overall contributing accounts growing

BUT INFLOWS ROSE MORE

Mutual fund houses, however, did not need to liquidate shares to meet these redemption requests. This is because new inflows into equity MFs spiked far more than redemption demands. In March 2026, investors poured ₹62,076 crore in new money into equity funds.

This led to net inflows into equity funds (after deducting redemptions) jumping to ₹40,450 crore in March 2026. Net flows were 56 per cent higher than February 2026 and 52 per cent higher than the average of ₹26,500 crore in the preceding five months.

It needs mention that equity MFs saw similar inflows of ₹41,887 crore in October 2024 (a 21 per cent jump) when the Nifty50 corrected over 8 per cent from its September peak. The Covid crash of March 2020 also saw a spike in net inflows into equity MFs.

All this suggests that equity MFs in India now have a sufficient number of seasoned investors, who double down on

their purchases after material corrections. However, historical trends suggest that while investors rush to buy the dip immediately after a sharp market fall, they begin holding back if the correction prolongs.

As of now though, the surge in equity inflows can help domestic institutions continue to hold the floor by offsetting FPI sales.

MISREADING SIPS

After the AMFI data was out, many commentators have been ringing alarm bells over the rising 'SIP stoppage ratio'. Along with inflows into different fund categories, AMFI gives out numbers on new SIPs (Systematic Investment Plans) started, SIPs stopped and the number of outstanding SIP accounts each month.

In March, there has been much hand-wringing over discontinued SIPs, at 53.3 lakh hitting a 'new record'. They also outnumbered new SIP additions (52.82 lakh) leading to worries about the 'SIP stoppage ratio' exceeding 100 per cent. Many folks read this as SIP investors withdrawing more money than they put in. But this is a faulty reading of the data.

One, the industry now has 9.71 crore contributing SIP accounts through which investors are steadily plowing money into MFs. It is this stock of SIP accounts that brings in the bulk of SIP flows. New account additions and account

stoppages are the tip of the iceberg, amounting to about 5 per cent of contributing accounts. In effect, though SIP closures overtook new additions in March, the stock of 9.71 crore existing SIP accounts continued. This is why monies flowing into MFs via SIPs at ₹32,087 crore saw an increase over February.

Two, while newer investors probably do stop SIPs when markets fall, not all SIP closures represent investors getting cold feet. Investors also routinely stop SIPs when they meet their financial goals, rebalance from one asset to another, or switch from an underperforming fund to a better one. As the number of SIP accounts held by the MF industry sets new records, SIP closures too will tend to organically rise.

Therefore, 'record' SIP closures are not particularly worrying. What should worry us is if the stock of contributing SIP accounts which stands at 9.71 crore, goes into a secular decline. The number of contributing SIP accounts is up from 7.74 crore in September 2024 (the market peak) to 9.71 crore now.

POPULAR CATEGORIES

As MF investors buy the dip, which segments of the market are receiving the most inflows? AMFI data on category-wise equity flows offers some cues.

MF investors seem to have a distinct partiality for mid-cap and small-cap stocks over large-

caps. This is evident from flexi-cap equity funds bagging the maximum inflows in March (₹10,054 crore), followed by mid-cap (₹6,064 crore) and small-cap funds (₹6,264 crore). Large-cap funds drew just ₹2,998 crore in inflows.

Investors seemed unsure which themes to bet on, as sectoral and thematic funds (flows of ₹2,699 crore) saw a dip compared to February. A section of investors though not large, indulged in bargain-hunting going by the inflows into value/contraria funds (₹2,425 crore in March against ₹901 crore in February).

DRY POWDER

While massive outflows from debt funds were only to be expected in March given advance tax obligations, hybrid funds suffering net outflows of ₹16,538 crore sprang a surprise. The bulk of this, however, came from arbitrage funds (outflows of ₹21,114 crore), which are used as parking grounds for short-term money.

This suggests that seasoned investors taking cash calls due to elevated valuations, probably decided to get back partly into equities in March. Arbitrage funds continued to manage ₹2.53 lakh crore as of March-end. This is probably the size of the dry powder held by MF investors looking to re-enter equities.

The author is a Contributing Editor

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0
Federal Bank	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.45	>=7.45	>=7.45
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20
IDBI Bank	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95
Karnataka Bank	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.70	>=7.70	>=7.70
Punjab National Bank	7.30-9.15	7.25-9.15	7.25-9.05
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
State Bank of India	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45
South Indian Bank	>=7.20	>=7.20	>=7.20
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
ICICI Bank	8.65-11.80	8.65-11.80	8.65-11.80
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.15-20	7.15-20	7.15-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on Apr 24, 2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com. * Annual percentage rate;



RAJAPALAYAM MILLS LIMITED
Regd. Office : Rajapalayam Mills Premises
P.A.C. Ramasamy Raja Salai, Post Box No.1, Rajapalayam - 626 117, Tamil Nadu.
CIN : L17111TN1936PLC002298 Telephone: 04563 - 235666, Fax: 04563 - 236520
Email: rajacot@ramcotex.com, Website: http://www.rajapalayammills.co.in

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
TRANSFER OF SHARES HAVING UNCLAIMED DIVIDEND TO INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND (IEPF)
In accordance with Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013, the shares in respect of which, dividend has not been paid or claimed for 7 consecutive years or more shall be transferred by the Company to IEPF Authority. The Government of India has notified Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016, [Rules], detailing the procedure for such transfer.
In accordance with that, the Company proposes to transfer to IEPF Authority the equity shares in respect of which dividends remain unclaimed for seven consecutive years or more.
The Company has sent individual notices through Registered Post to the Shareholders, whose dividends are lying unclaimed for the last seven consecutive years or more, advising them to claim the dividend expeditiously.
In terms of Rule 6(3) of the Rules, the statement containing the details of the Shareholders and the shares due for transfer is available on the Company's website, www.rajapalayammills.co.in for information and necessary action by the Shareholders.
In case, no valid claim is received for the dividend on or before 25th July, 2026, the equity shares in respect of such unclaimed dividend will be transferred to IEPF Authority in accordance with the Rules, on or before 12th September, 2026.
In the event of the Shareholders not claiming the dividend and the shares are transferred to IEPF Authority, the Shareholders are still entitled to claim the shares from IEPF Authority by making an online application to the IEPF Authority. The procedure is available at www.iepf.gov.in and at www.rajapalayammills.co.in and the form is available at www.mca.gov.in.

For **RAJAPALAYAM MILLS LIMITED**
K. MAHESWARAN
SECRETARY

RAJAPALAYAM
25-04-2026

Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance Company Limited



ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL
LIFE INSURANCE

ADITYA BIRLA SUN LIFE INSURANCE COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: U99999MH2000PLC12810
Registered Office: One World Centre, Tower 1, 16th Floor, Jupiter Mill Compound, 841, S. B. Marg, Elphinstone Road, Mumbai, Maharashtra, India, 400013 | Tel: +91 22 67239203
E-mail: absli.secretarial@adityabirlacapital.com; Website: https://lifeinsurance.adityabirlacapital.com/

AUDITED STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026

The Audited Standalone & Consolidated Financial Results of Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance Company Limited ("the Company") for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 including any modified opinion(s) or reservation(s), if any have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their meetings held on April 24, 2026 in terms of Regulation 52 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

The aforementioned financial results along with Auditor's Report thereon are available on the website of BSE (www.bseindia.com) and NSE (www.nseindia.com) and on the Company's website at <https://lifeinsurance.adityabirlacapital.com/about-us/investors/>

The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below:



Scan the QR Code to view the Results on the website of the Company

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance Company Limited

Place: Mumbai
Date : April 24, 2026

Kamlesh Rao
Managing Director & CEO
(DIN: 07665616)

An Aditya Birla Group Company
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INF/A/26-27/173



IDFC FIRST Bank Limited

Registered Office: KRM Towers, 7th Floor, No. 1 Harrington Road, Chetpet, Chennai - 600031, Tamilnadu
Corporate Office: IDFC FIRST Bank Tower, The Square, C-61, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400051.
Website: www.idfcfirst.bank.in, Email: bank.info@idfcfirstbank.com, CIN: L65110TN2014PLC097792

STATEMENT OF AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (Refer Note 3)	Year ended 31.03.2026	Quarter ended 31.03.2025 (Refer Note 3)	Year ended 31.03.2025	Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (Refer Note 3)	Year ended 31.03.2026	Quarter ended 31.03.2025 (Refer Note 3)	Year ended 31.03.2025
1	Total Income from Operations	12,18,281	48,42,211	11,30,835	43,52,320	12,18,297	48,42,239	11,30,842	43,47,830
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	18,930	1,83,281	36,114	1,90,012	20,099	1,80,700	34,432	1,86,417
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	18,930	1,83,281	36,114	1,90,012	20,099	1,80,700	34,432	1,86,417
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	31,894	1,63,636	30,408	1,52,485	33,064	1,61,056	29,560	1,49,035
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)) (refer note no. 2)	NA	NA	NA	NA	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.
6	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value ₹ 10 per share)	8,60,170	8,60,170	7,32,211	7,32,211	8,60,170	8,60,170	7,32,211	7,32,211
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	38,46,227 (As at 31 March 2026)	38,46,227 (As at 31 March 2026)	30,60,717 (As at 31 March 2025)	30,60,717 (As at 31 March 2025)	38,51,424 (As at 31 March 2026)	38,51,424 (As at 31 March 2026)	30,68,495 (As at 31 March 2025)	30,68,495 (As at 31 March 2025)
8	Securities Premium Account	22,88,233	22,88,233	16,53,154	16,53,154				
9	Net worth	46,29,708	46,29,708	37,14,064	37,14,064				
10	Outstanding Debt	36,62,068	36,62,068	38,97,484	38,97,484				
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares								
12	Debt Equity Ratio	0.39	0.39	0.30	0.30				
13	Earnings Per Share (Face value ₹ 10 per share) (for continuing and discontinued operations) - not annualized								
	- Basic (₹)	0.37	1.93	0.42	2.09	0.38	1.89	0.40	2.04
	- Diluted (₹)	0.37	1.91	0.41	2.08	0.38	1.88	0.40	2.03
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
15	Debt Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Notes:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly / annual financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of quarterly / annual financial results are available on the Bank's website (www.idfcfirst.bank.in) and on the Stock Exchange(s) websites (www.nseindia.com) and (www.bseindia.com).
- Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and Other Comprehensive Income are not furnished as Indian Accounting Standards (Ind-AS) is not yet made applicable to the Banks.
- The figures for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 and March 31, 2025 are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of the financial year and the published year to date figures upto the end of the third quarter of the relevant financial year which were subject to limited review.
- The figures for the previous quarter / period have been regrouped / reclassified wherever necessary in order to make them comparable.



For and behalf of the Board of Directors
of IDFC FIRST Bank Limited

Sd/-
V. Vaidyanathan
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: April 25, 2026
Place: Mumbai

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

ICICI Prudential Equity and Debt Fund (IEDF) is among the few schemes that have consistently maintained a high rating under the *bl.portfolio* Star Track MF ratings, earning either five stars or four stars since the framework was introduced in October 2018. In the latest edition, it holds a five-star rating, reflecting its ability to generate relatively strong risk-adjusted returns within its category.

Earlier known as ICICI Prudential Balanced Fund, it is one of the oldest hybrid funds in the Indian mutual fund industry. Since its launch in November 1999, the fund has delivered a compounded annualised return of around 15 per cent. With assets under management of ₹46,700 crore, it is currently the second-largest fund in its category, after SBI Equity Hybrid Fund, which manages ₹76,292 crore as of March 2026.

In line with SEBI guidelines for aggressive hybrid schemes, IEDF allocates a majority of its portfolio to equities, typically within the 65–80 per cent range, while the balance is deployed in debt instruments. The fund follows a rule-based asset allocation framework that guides shifts between equity and debt using a mix of valuation metrics and macroeconomic signals.

Valuations form the core of the model, while macro indicators play a supporting role. These include factors such as crude oil prices and liquidity conditions, which are not fixed but are periodically refined to reflect evolving economic realities. Over the past five years, its equity allocation has largely stayed in the 65–75 per cent band, adjusting in response to changing market conditions.

EQUITY ALLOCATION

In equities, stock selection is guided by a contrarian, bottom-up, and counter-cyclical approach. Under the contrarian strategy, the fund invests in out-of-favour sectors when market sentiment is negative. For instance, about a year ago, amid concerns that quick commerce would disrupt traditional retail, the fund considered these fears overdone. It increased exposure to stocks like Trent and Avenue Supermarts, expecting resilience, as it believed quick commerce lacked durable competitive advantages. However, these additions have yet to deliver meaningful returns. The counter-cyclical strategy involves investing in sectors undergoing temporary downturns or heightened competitive pressure.

The fund has benefitted from such allocations in the past, particularly in sectors such as power, metals, autos, and telecom, where it capitalised on recovery phases. A contrarian strategy means buying what others are avoiding and selling what's popular. A counter-cyclical strategy means adjusting based on the economy, taking more risk in bad times and be-



Balancing risk & return

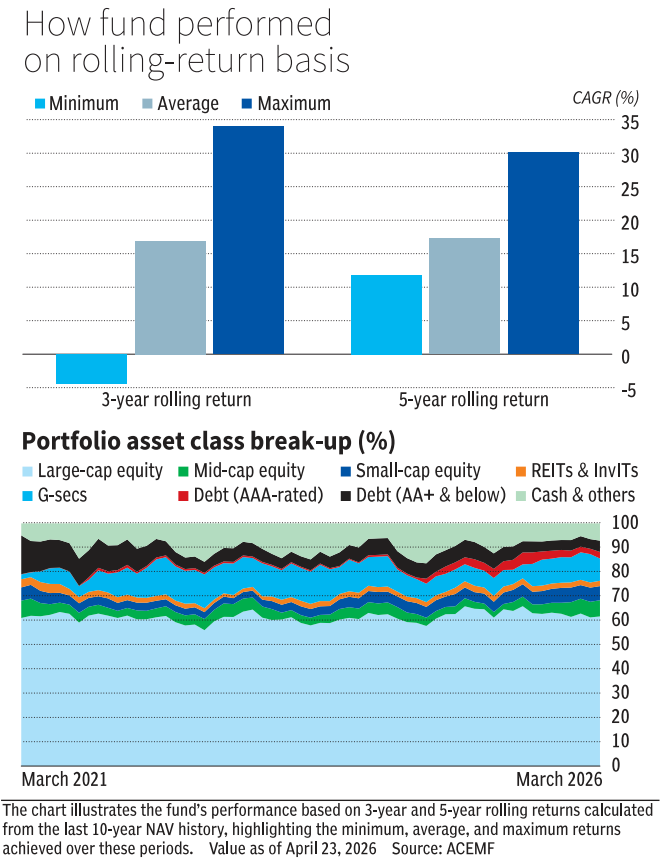
FUND CALL. ICICI Pru Equity and Debt Fund is suited for new investors in equity market and those with a moderate risk profile



WHY INVEST

- Category beating return
- Large-cap oriented equity portfolio
- Dynamic debt allocation

coming cautious in good times. One follows sentiment; the other follows economic cycles. The overall equity portfolio currently shows overweight positions in power, pharmaceuticals, and automobiles, along with selective exposure to retail-oriented stocks. Banking is maintained at an equal weight, while IT remains underweight. The top three sectors were banks (15 per cent), auto (5 per cent), and pharma (6 per cent) as of March 2026. Over the past year, the fund increased its allocation to FMCG, IT, and petroleum products by 2–3 per cent, while reducing exposure to banks, auto, and telecom by 2–4 per cent. The fund has demonstrated a clear preference for large-cap stocks, maintaining an average allocation of 60 per cent to large-caps over the last five years. Apart from this, only two other funds from Quant MF and Groww MF follow a large-cap oriented approach in the category. However, it has recently



increased exposure to mid- and small-cap stocks, especially during market corrections. Twelve out of 29 funds increased their allocation to mid- and small-cap stocks during the period, including funds from Kotak MF and Union MF. Currently, the large-, mid-, and small-cap allocation stands at 62 per cent, 7 per cent, and 6 per cent, respectively.

DEBT ALLOCATION The fund manages its debt portion within the requirement of maintaining at least 20 per cent exposure to fixed-income instruments, using a flexible and actively managed approach. It balances short- and long-term securities and shifts between accrual and duration strategies de-

pending on interest rate trends. When rates are rising, the focus is on earning higher yields by increasing exposure to AA-rated papers with better spreads, as seen in 2020–2021, when such exposure rose to 24 per cent. In contrast, when rate cuts are anticipated, the fund increases allocation to government securities and high-rated instruments to benefit from duration gains. This was evident in 2024–2025, when AAA and G-sec exposure rose to 17 per cent. Currently, G-sec and AAA exposure stands at about 15 per cent, while exposure to non-AAA papers has reduced to around 5 per cent. The present portfolio includes small allocations to A-rated issuers such as Adani Cap-

ital and Bamboo Hotel and Global Centre (Delhi), along with AA-rated names like 360 One Prime, JM Financial Credit Solutions, Manappuram Finance, and Vedanta. The Macaulay duration of the portfolio has ranged from 1 year to 4.6 years and currently stands at 3.7 years. Simply put, Macaulay duration indicates how long, on average, it takes for a debt fund to recover its invested capital through bond cash flows, including interest payments. As of March, 2026, the fund's debt portfolio reported a yield to maturity of 7.7 per cent, compared with the category average of 7.5 per cent.

PERFORMANCE A look at five-year rolling returns over the last 10 years shows that the fund posted an average annual return of 18 per cent, significantly outperforming the category average of 14 per cent. The five-year return range has varied between 11.8 per cent and 30 per cent, indicating both resilience and upside potential. The fund also demonstrated strong performance in three-year rolling returns, delivering a 17 per cent CAGR compared with the category average of 13 per cent. From a cost perspective, the regular plan has an expense ratio of 1.54 per cent, lower than the category average of 2 per cent. The direct plan, however, has an expense ratio of 0.94 per cent, slightly higher than the category average of 0.84 per cent. Investors new to equity markets who want limited exposure to equity risk, as well as those with a moderate risk profile, can consider this fund. Given the current volatile environment, investing through a systematic route is preferable, with a minimum investment horizon of five years.

Defence sector on fire, but at a premium

SECTOR TRACKER. In India, capital outlay for defence services has grown at 10 per cent CAGR in FY21-26 which includes a 22% growth this year

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

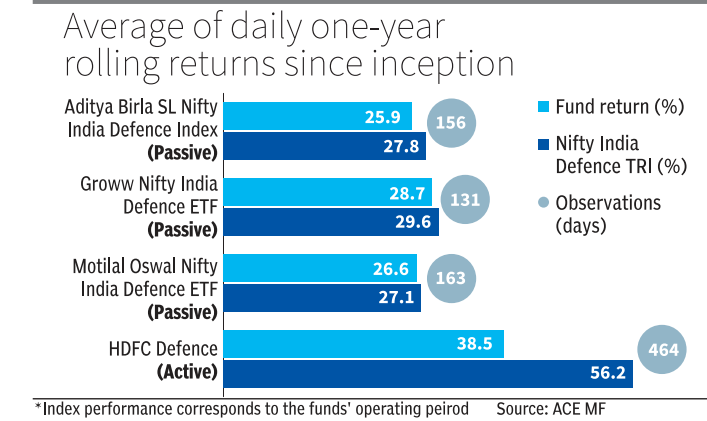
Nifty India Defence index, in the four years since launch, has grown at an astounding pace of 52 per cent CAGR compared to 8.2 per cent for Nifty 50 in the period. Defence sector is in the midst of an upcycle that is likely to sustain at least in the medium term. But the index valuations (one year forward PE) at a 30 per cent premium to last four-year average (44 times versus 34 times average) should temper investor interest despite the strong outlook. We examine the primary sector drivers and provide an outlook for key index constituents. Alongside, we highlight mutual funds tracking the sector for investors seeking an exposure.

SECTOR DRIVERS

Defence spending has been elevated in India and also rest of the world. In India, capital outlay for defence services has grown at 10 per cent CAGR in FY21-26 which includes a 22-per cent growth this year. European nations of NATO alliance have committed to increase their proportion of defence spending from 2 per cent to 5 per cent of GDP by 2035. With US,

Russia and Israel locked in conflicts of their own, defence spending is on an upward cycle across major economies. Domestically, the high spending has been complemented by a policy of indigenisation as well which mandates Indian design, developed and manufactured supply chain. Positive indigenisation lists, PLI schemes, dedicated defence corridors, defence acquisition procedure and gradual opening of export markets for private and public defence companies have provided strong policy support to the growth that should support strong margins.

SECTOR CONSTITUENTS As on March 30, 2026 Nifty India Defence index has 19 constituents with Bharat Electronics (BEL), HAL, Bharat Forge, Solar Industries and Mazagon Dock accounting for 20, 20, 16, 11 and 6 per cent of index by weight respectively. The common factor for the key constituents is a large order book that provides revenue visibility for next three to four years. BEL is central to the three-armed forces with its competency as a integrator of electronic systems and subsystems. With LCA Tejas, next-genera-



tion Corvettes, and missiles, BEL order book spans the three branches of the armed forces. In the next wave of orders; Project Kusha, AMCA and P-75I submarine will involve sizeable orders for systems integration for BEL. For HAL, on one side, the significant shortfall of fighter squadrons for Airforce places a large demand on deliveries which may start ramping in FY27. But on the other hand, significant delays in GE engines for Tejas and risk of private competition or order delays/downsizing are an overhang on HAL. The company has visibility from other more reliable platforms including Sukhoi upgrades

and Prachand light combat helicopters, that alleviate the risk to an extent. On the sea front, current and expected order book from Indian Navy that includes P17A frigates nearing completion for one of four orders and next generation submarine P-75I which is expected to be announced shortly, support a healthy order book visibility for Mazagon and also Cochin Shipyard and GRSE in next few years. The timely contract signing and order book execution are key monitorables. While the large companies anchor the large projects, the indigenisation policy has allowed new private players to expand their ad-



POINT TO NOTE We recommend investors gain a passive long-term exposure to the sector, only when valuations cool

dressable markets in defence contracts. Bharat Forge's current defence contribution is around 10 per cent of revenues. The company has secured orders in diverse defence verticals including drones, unmanned vehicles, small guns, and ATAGS (Advanced Towed Artillery Gun System).

The defence proportions should grow to 20-30 per cent of revenues in the medium term as per the company. This, in addition to its auto and industrial business, are also in an upcycle. Similarly, Data Patterns should benefit from the larger orders of radar and electronic warfare suites for aircraft and submarines. Zen Technologies primarily focusses on simulators and anti-drone systems. The company has recently bagged a licence to manufacture cannons for air defence expanding its addressable market. Astra Microwave's software-designed radio systems or Paras' optronics systems are in the next phase of development. **FUND OPTIONS** While the sector is enjoying strong momentum, there are only a few mutual funds. Aditya Birla, Groww and Motilal Oswal have passive funds tracking Nifty India Defence sector while HDFC Defence Fund is the only active option in the sector. All the funds were launched only in the last 3-4 years. Axis MF also launched a passive fund recently. Our analysis is constrained by the shorter performance track record. In the limited timeframe for analysis, HDFC Defence fund has underperformed the Nifty India Defence index significantly. The daily one-year rolling return average since the fund launch at 38.5 per cent is still lower compared to index average of 56.2 per cent. Amongst the passive funds, Motilal Oswal has tracked the index closely in its period of performance. We recommend investors gain a passive exposure to the sector. The sector revenue momentum should last through next 3-4 years with the current order book and geopolitical climate. With valuations at a high, investors can wait for it to cool down and gain a margin of safety for long-term exposure.

ALERTS.

Invesco MF launches Nifty Bank Index Fund

Invesco Mutual Fund has launched Invesco India Nifty Bank Index Fund, an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the Nifty Bank Index. The NFO closes on May 7, 2026. The entry load is not applicable and the exit load is nil for the scheme. The minimum subscription amount is ₹100 per application and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked against Nifty Bank TRI; its fund manager is Abhisek Bahinipati. The objective is passive investments in equity and equity related securities replicating the composition of the Nifty Bank Index, subject to tracking errors.

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR						
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Apr 24	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)	
		3-year	5-year	10-year		
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	53.4	14.4	13.6	13.8	69,293	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.9	15.7	14.4	13.6	25,125	
Kotak Pension Fund	66.7	15.1	14.3	13.5	4,151	
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS						
LIC Pension Fund	30.6	6.7	6.0	8.3	8,421	
SBI Pension Fund	41.0	6.7	5.9	7.8	27,519	
HDFC Pension Fund	28.1	6.3	5.6	7.7	50,159	
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	30.1	7.9	6.9	8.2	33,108	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.3	7.7	6.7	8.0	13,143	
SBI Pension Fund	45.5	7.7	6.6	8.0	14,868	
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	46.1	14.4	13.6	13.9	1,673	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.6	15.5	14.4	13.6	700	
Kotak Pension Fund	58.5	15.0	14.2	13.4	202	

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on April 24, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns						
AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)			
			1-year	3-year	5-year	
LARGE CAP						
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	-5.0	16.2	18.5	
ICICI Pru	Largecap	768	-1.3	17.7	16.3	
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	-1.5	16.6	14.0	
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-8.2	11.7	13.6	
MULTI CAP						
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	108	11.2	29.8	23.7	
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	106	2.0	28.4	23.6	
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	971	8.5	24.2	22.6	
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	8,689	6.0	21.0	22.0	
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	5,833	-2.6	31.5	21.6	
Negen Capital Services	Special Situ & Tech Strategy	1,133	-2.1	24.3	21.4	
MID-CAP						
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	312	2.0	13.0	15.9	
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-5.3	13.3	15.9	
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	-4.1	13.6	15.5	
Nippon Life India Asset Mgmt	Emerging India	NA	0.1	17.4	14.1	
SMALL CAP						
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,788	43.5	45.5	44.6	
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	712	-14.0	17.7	33.6	
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,046	-19.5	28.3	22.9	
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	-4.4	25.6	21.0	

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on March 31, 2026

After the wash, fabric holds strong

FMCG. Jyothy Labs offers better risk-reward as business steadies over time

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Jyothy Labs, a mid-tier home and personal care FMCG player with brands such as Ujala, Henko and Exo, has seen its stock correct meaningfully over the past year after an earlier sharp run-up. *bl.portfolio* had recommended partial profit-book- ing in July 2024 (₹480 levels) ant- icipating a moderation in earnings growth after a sharp re- rating. We moved to an accumu- late stance in April 2025 (₹360 levels) after the stock corrected.

Jyothy Labs shares have since then corrected further by about 30 per cent over the past year to ₹259.50, underperforming most FMCG peers such as Hindustan Unilever (down 2 per cent), Godrej Consumer (down 7 per cent), Marico (up 10 per cent) and Dabur India (flat), as earnings growth slowed and valuations compressed. Though Colgate-Palmolive, P & G Hy- giene and Emami have also cor- rected 14-24 per cent, Jyothy Labs has been hit the hardest.

While near-term growth re- mains subdued, early signs of stabilisation in the company are evident. Q3FY26 saw decent volume growth, recovery in per- sonal care and household insect- icides, and continued strength in fabric care, alongside improv- ing rural demand and traction in modern trade and e-commerce channels. Other positives in- clude a net-debt free balance sheet, healthy volume growth despite weak pricing, improving mix in liquid detergents and va- porisers, wider direct reach and early repair in weak segments.

The stock trades at 24 times one-year forward earnings, at an attractive 20 per cent discount to its five-year average of 30 times, and is also cheaper than peers. Thus, the risk-reward has turned more favourable. We re- commend long-term investors with a three-five year horizon can buy the stock. Drivers dis- cussed in detail below.

BUSINESS PROFILE

Started in 1983, Jyothy Labs began its journey selling just

● **BUY**

Jyothy Labs ₹259.50

WHY

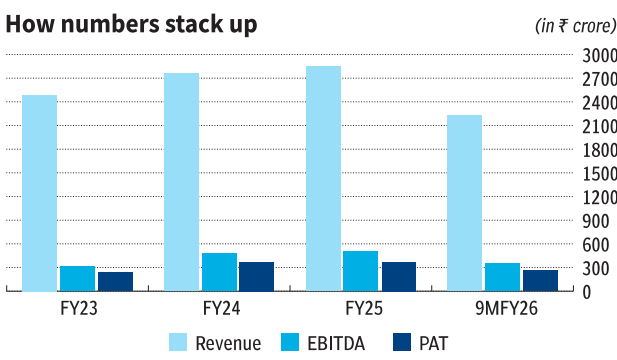
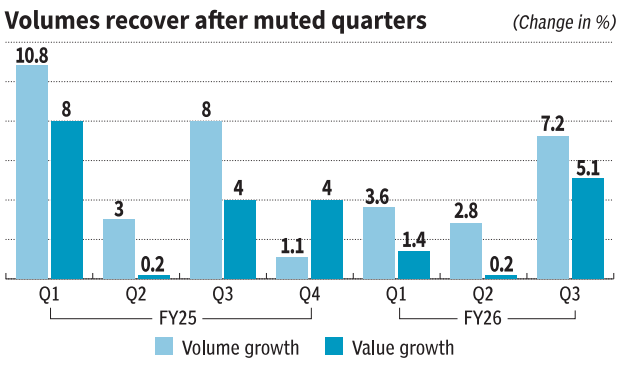
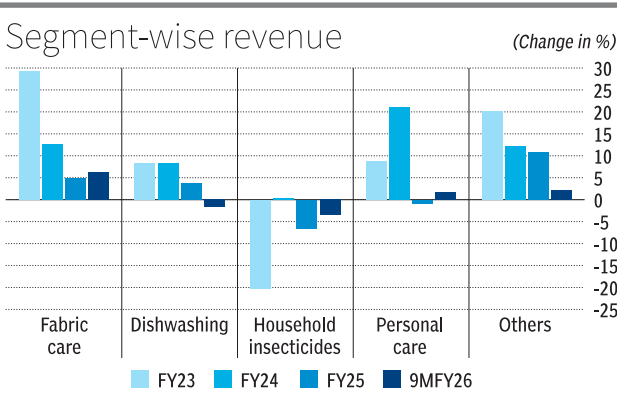
- Valuation discount offers attractive entry point
- Volume growth steady despite weak pricing
- Balance sheet strong with net cash position

one brand liquid fabric whitener ‘Ujala Supreme’. Over the years, it has established presence in key categories — fabric care, dish wash, household insect- icides and personal care. Its products are available directly in 1.3 million outlets pan-India, boasts of nearly 10,000 channel partners and has nearly two dozen manufacturing plants. In fabric care, it has brands includ- ing Ujala, Henko, Mr. White, More Light, Dr.Wool, Super Chek and Speed. In home care, there is Maxo, T-Shine and Maya, while its personal care range spans Margo, Neem Act- ive, FA and Jovia. Dish wash products include Exo and Pril.

Fabric care continues to be the largest segment (44 per cent of FY25 revenue), followed by dish wash (34 per cent), per- sonal care (11 per cent) and household insecticides (7 per cent).

Volume growth refers to the increase in the number of units sold. Value growth refers to the increase in total revenue from those sales. For 9MFY26, Fabric Care grew 6.2 per cent in value, supported by a robust 7 per cent volume growth and helped by li- quid detergents that nearly doubled in both volume and value terms. Personal care seg- ment registered a staid 1.8 per cent value growth, mostly price-led.

However, Dish wash segment experienced a 1.7 per cent de- cline in value, despite delivering more than 6 per cent volume growth. The management at- tributed this disconnect to price cuts, extra grammage and pro- motional offers. Household in- secticides revenue was down 3.5



Source: Company filings

per cent for the nine-month period, still weak but better than the over 7 per cent decline seen in 9MFY25 period.

FINANCIALS

For 9MFY26, Jyothy Labs repor- ted an overall revenue growth of 2.2 per cent in value terms and 4.5 per cent in volume growth. Gross margins declined during 9MFY26 to 47.5 per cent from 50.4 per cent, primarily due to MRP cuts and lower sales real- isation. This is especially for the dish wash and liquid detergent categories. Advertising and pro- motion (A&P) spend was about 8 per cent vs. operational rev-

enue in 9MFY26. Sustained brand investments and innova- tions are key to driving growth.

Elevated input prices of se- lect raw materials, also had an impact, though the manage- ment expects gradual stability in raw material prices, going for- ward. However, geopolitical volatility and forex fluctuations continue to remain watch points. Operating EBITDA mar- gins shrunk by 190 bps to 15.9 per cent, mostly due to gross margin hit. The company is ex- pected to give greater focus on premium product sales and scale-up of new launches, which should ease margin pressures.

9MFY26 PAT stood at ₹266 crore vs. ₹294 crore in the year- ago period. After an estimated 4.1 per cent decline in adjusted EPS for full-year FY26, con- sensus expects its growth to be over 10 per cent in FY27, per Bloomberg. It has over ₹750 crore of cash.

CATALYSTS

Growth drivers for Jyothy Labs are more visible now than in the previous few quarters. In Q3FY26, the company reported 7.2 per cent volume growth, with fabric care growing 9.2 per cent in value terms. Within fab- ric care, the liquid detergent portfolio delivered high double- digit volume growth, while the newly-launched Dr. Wool re- ceived a good initial response. Personal care grew 11 per cent in value terms, helped by the Margo franchise returning to profitable growth.

Household insecticides, a weak spot earlier, grew 12.6 per cent in value terms, led by volume growth. The company is reducing focus on coils and shifting towards liquid vapor- isers and aerosols, which are better-margin formats. The management expects this cat- egory to be completely turned around by the end of FY27. Even dish wash, where value declined due to competitive pricing, saw 7 per cent volume growth.

New products such as Jovia (personal care) and Ujala In- stant Dirt Dissolvers in select States have met internal success parameters, as per the manage- ment. Jyothy Labs’ laundry business, Fabric Spa (end-to- end garment care, including dry cleaning, wet washing, and doorstep pick-up/delivery), is now a division under the parent company and reported under “others” segment. The company is focused on a retail franchisee model, with over 200 outlets across a few States. The busi- ness is growing reasonably, has largely arrested cash losses, and is being gradually moved to- wards profitability.

Also, growth witnessed in modern trade and quick com- merce can support eventual premium product expansion.

and the segment’s likely vulnera- bility to the ongoing West Asia con- flict, investors need to track any changes to the guidance in the up- coming results for Q4 FY26.

With only secured exposure, the bank is otherwise stable with a capital adequacy ratio (CRAR) of 30.1 per cent, gross and net NPA ratios at 0.9 per cent and 0.2 per cent, with contained slippages and credit cost. With MSME loans ramping up, the segment’s slip- pages might rise but not too much to move the GNPA ratio beyond 1.25 per cent, per the manage- ment. Further, the bank is also not likely to be materially impacted by the upcoming expected credit loss and liquidity coverage norms.

FEMA PENALTIES

The genesis of the penalties traces back to 1994, when shareholders holding two-thirds of the bank’s shares had sold their shares to the Essar group. The RBI declined to recognise this transfer, as it disfa- voured links between banks and industrial houses. Hence, the Nadar Mahajana Bank Share In- vestors Forum was floated to identify willing investors to buy the stake back. In 2007, about half of such shares were transferred to 216 investors, which include seven non-resident entities. Transfer of shares to these seven entities was in contravention of FEMA and thus, forms the bone of contention.

In FY17, the bank decided to is- sue bonus shares (1:500 ratio), as the book value per share reached close to ₹1 lakh. Since bonus shares were issued against those whose transfers were in contra- vention of law, the ED shot no- tices to the bank with penalties totalling to ₹1,037 crore in FY18. An appeal has been lodged against this, and the case is still pending. The penalties work out to about 10 per cent of net worth. How- ever, the bank has obtained legal opinion and according to it, the maximum penalty applicable if the alleged offence is established is ₹2 lakh. This is because the mat- ter involves only the issuance of bonus shares, with no actual funds received against their allotment.

So far, the management’s guid- ance for FY27 stand as follows: Loan growth of 16-17 per cent, net interest margin to hold up between 3.8 per cent and 4 per cent (Q3 FY26 margin at 4 per cent; higher gold loan share and deposit repricing to aid) and a profit growth of about 20 per cent (plus or minus 3 per cent on either side). Given TMB’s 30 per cent concentration to MSME segment

Banking on valuation comfort

BANKING. With growth back on track in H2 of FY26, Tamilnad Mercantile Bank’s risk-reward equation turns favourable

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

We had given a ‘hold’ call on the stock of Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB) in late-July 2024. The price then was ₹463. Ever since, the stock broadly traded in a range until late-October last year. Fuelled by the management’s op- timistic commentary after Q2 FY26 results in late-October, the stock started to climb to mark an all-time high of ₹720 by February 23, 2026—a return of 56 per cent in about one-and-a-half years at this point. Today, TMB shares trade 10 per cent lower than this all-time high. The bank’s finan- cials have largely remained stable during this period, maintaining a healthy RoA at around 1.9 per cent.

Though delivering an RoA of a similar 1.8 per cent for FY24 and trading at an inexpensive valua- tion of 0.9x book value, we had given a conservative ‘hold’ call back then due to three reasons. One, the bank was being run without an MD at the helm, but by a committee of executives. Two, loan growth was lacklustre rela- tive to the banking system. Three, we had lower clarity on the finan- cial impact of certain penalties imposed by the ED (Enforcement Directorate). These relate to a leg- acy case involving the bank’s issua- nce of bonus shares on holdings of certain non-resident share- holders—the underlying transfer through which such shareholders acquired the original shares being alleged to contravene the Foreign Exchange Management (FEMA) law.

Now, there is improvement on all three aspects. The incumbent MD, a former SBI banker, was ap- pointed late-August 2024 for three years. How things are look- ing up now on growth and the penalties is discussed in detail below.

However, the overhang from legacy litigations relating to shareholdings (as to who is the rightful owner) still remains. Today, the bank classifies about 9 per cent of outstanding shares as subject matters of court cases, in



How peers stack up

	Loan book (₹ crore)*	P/B (x)	RoA (%)*	NNPA ratio (%)#	CRAR (%)#
TMB	50,763	1.1	1.9	0.2	30.1
Karur Vysya Bank	97,052	2.1	1.9	0.2	16.1
City Union Bank	60,892	1.9	1.6	0.8	20.1
CSB bank	37,161	1.4	1.2	0.7	19.4
South Indian Bank	96,764	0.9	1.1	0.5	17.8
Karnataka Bank	77,283	0.7	1.0	1.3	19.9

*for 9M FY26 annualised #as of December 2025

Source: Exchange filings

its shareholding pattern. When these cases are decided in the fu- ture, while they may affect the shareholders involved, they may not necessarily impact the bank’s financials. TMB is otherwise a professionally-run bank with no identifiable promoter. About 92 per cent of the shares are held by the public, with no investor’s stake surpassing 5 per cent individually.

That said, at 1.1x book value and having delivered an RoA of 1.9 per cent (9M FY26 annualised), it still trades cheap relative to its re- gional private banking peers (see table). For instance, City Union Bank trades at 1.9x book value, but its RoA is a lower 1.6 per cent. Larger peer Karur Vysya trades at twice TMB’s multiple for an identical RoA and net NPA ratio. With growth back on track in the second half of FY26 and expected to continue into FY27, the risk-re- ward equation in our view, is fa- vourable for an entry at current valuation. Hence long-term in-

vestors can accumulate the stock.

GROWTH BACK ON TRACK

Before discussing growth, here is some context. TMB’s loan book amounts to ₹50,673 crore. Retail, agriculture, MSME and corporate segments share it in a 28:36:29:6 ratio. Almost 90 per cent of agri loans are jewel loans and about half of the retail loans are jewel loans as well. Thus, gold loans make about 46 per cent of the loan book. The other loans are backed by collateral too, as unsecured loans make a negligible 0.1 per cent of the book.

In FY24, credit growth was just 6.4 per cent against a system loan growth of over 20 per cent. It im- proved to 11 per cent in FY25, at par with the system (though a higher rate is desirable for its smaller size). Even in H1 FY26, credit grew at a slower 10.3 per cent vs the system’s 11.4 per cent. This is primarily due to a trans- formation exercise the bank is go- ing through, with substantial up-

● **ACCUMULATE**

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank ₹640.05

WHY

- Growth on the cards
- Solid fundamentals
- Relatively undervalued

grades to systems. Traditionally, the bank has been underwriting loans manually at the branch and this became an impediment to scale. Branch staff couldn’t focus on gathering deposits either. De- posit growth in FY24 and FY25 were mere 3.7 per cent and 8.4 per cent.

Now, the bank has set up re- gion-wise credit management centres to handle the underwrit- ing function. Branches would merely generate leads. However, underwriting of simpler gold loans and loans against deposits will still be with the branches. TMB is also modernising its soft- ware suite including loan origina- tion and loan management (ap- praisal through post-disbursement stages) sys- tems. These upgrades have largely come online, with residual imple- mentation expected in FY27.

This meant, by 9M FY26, loans, deposits and net profit grew 16.3 per cent, 12.5 per cent and 18 per cent (adjusted for one-time re- coveries from written-off ac- counts in 9M FY25). Profit growth in FY24 and FY25 were 4.2 per cent and 10.3 per cent, for context. Per its provisional fig- ures for Q4 FY26, loans and de- posit growth have further im- proved to 20.3 per cent and 14.9 per cent.

So far, the management’s guid- ance for FY27 stand as follows: Loan growth of 16-17 per cent, net interest margin to hold up between 3.8 per cent and 4 per cent (Q3 FY26 margin at 4 per cent; higher gold loan share and deposit repricing to aid) and a profit growth of about 20 per cent (plus or minus 3 per cent on either side). Given TMB’s 30 per cent concentration to MSME segment

Taking Stock • bl • 5

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, ‘what is your India plan?’ is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. With the March quarter coming to a close, this column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. Here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

Philip Morris International Inc. (PM, \$263.7 billion)

The tobacco major said regulatory changes in India are weighing on industry volumes in the near term.

“We expect cigarette volume declines of around 3 per cent for the year, including a negative impact in India following the introduction of new excise rates in Q1.”

Nestlé S.A. (NESN, CHF205.8 billion)

Nestlé highlighted India as a core growth platform supported by strong brands, distribution and continued investment.

“India is a growth platform for us, where we will continue to step up investments. With strong brands like Maggi, robust distribution, and ongoing innovation, we are seeing clear results from our strategy.”

Orkla ASA (ORK, Nkr117.2 billion)



Orkla reaffirmed its long-term commitment to India following the listing of its local subsidiary. “We listed Orkla India while retaining a 75 per cent stake, reflecting our confidence in the market’s growth potential. The listing strengthens our ability to capture local opportunities and expand the business further.”

Essilor Luxottica (EL, €88.6 billion)

The eyewear giant said India is emerging as a key growth market for its new AI-enabled products.

“Ray-Ban AI glasses are already contributing meaningfully to growth in India, supporting our strategy to expand this category in fast-growing markets and replicate success seen in more mature regions.”

Reckitt Benckiser Group plc (RKT, £30.7 billion)

Reckitt highlighted India as a key growth driver with strong performance across its core brands.

“India delivered double-digit growth across all categories, led by strong performances from Dettol and Durex. Expanded distribution reach continues to support growth of our market-leading brands.”

Bonesupport Holding AB (publ) (BONEX, Skr16.3 billion)

The Swedish medical technology company sees India as an attractive niche opportunity following its CERAMENT launch.

“We launched CERAMENT in India focusing on the private healthcare segment, working with leading hospital chains. Even within this niche, the opportunity is sizable and offers margins comparable to our European distributor markets.”

Beiersdorf AG (BEI, €16.2 billion)

The skincare major reported strong growth in India, led by NIVEA’s expanding portfolio and market share gains.

“NIVEA grew 18 per cent in India with market share gains across all categories. New launches like Luminous and strong performance from NIVEA Soft, where India is our largest market, are driving continued momentum.”

Gaztransport & Technigaz SA (GTT, €7.5 billion)

The French LNG technology firm highlighted India’s growing energy demand and its implications for global shipping.

“Around 60 per cent of India’s gas imports currently come from the Middle East, which will require diversification and increased shipping capacity, implying additional LNG vessel demand over the medium term.”

Accor SA (AS, €9.7 billion)

The French hospitality giant said India remains a priority market with accelerating development momentum.

“We signed or advanced 46 hotels in India over the last six months, representing 63 per cent of our existing network. This reflects a sharp acceleration in development across both premium and luxury segments.”

Visteon Corporation (VC, \$2.9 billion)

The US automotive component maker highlighted India as a key growth driver, supported by new product launches and strong OEM partnerships.

“India now represents nearly 10 per cent of our total sales, with multiple launches across Hyundai, Tata and Renault. We also secured a SmartCore cockpit domain controller win, positioning us to grow alongside customers in one of the fastest-growing auto markets.”

Valeo SE (FR, €2.7 billion)

Valeo is expanding its manufacturing footprint in India to support rapid growth in the automotive sector.

“We are launching new manufacturing lines in Pune and Sanand for electric powertrain systems and vision cameras, supporting major OEMs. Momentum in India remains strong in line with our Elevate roadmap.”

Contributed by **NAFA**
ASSET MANAGERS

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 I am a global leader serving customers across all six continents and control 40 per cent of the domestic market as well.
- 2 While 90 per cent of my target customers are women, they make up less than 10 per cent of my workforce.
- 3 Repeated corporate governance concerns might have prevented strong institutional interest, with institutions holding only a single-digit stake.
- 4 I reached a billion-dollar market capitalisation last decade and am still valued below that.
- 5 My cash conversion cycle takes more than a year as my product segment requires large inventory.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by **UNIFI CAPITAL**
Last week’s stock: Rane (Madras)
Last week’s winner: Amarjit K

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,898) and Nifty Bank (56,090) snapped a two week rally as both indices fell last week. While the former lost 1.8 per cent the latter was down 0.8 per cent.

The FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) increased their bearish exposure over the past week by adding net short on index futures and index call options and by adding net long on index put options.

Broadly, at the moment, the derivatives data indicate some weakness whereas the chart shows that the correction may be temporary. Below is our analysis.

Note that derivative contracts from May series are considered since April contracts will expire on Tuesday (April 28).

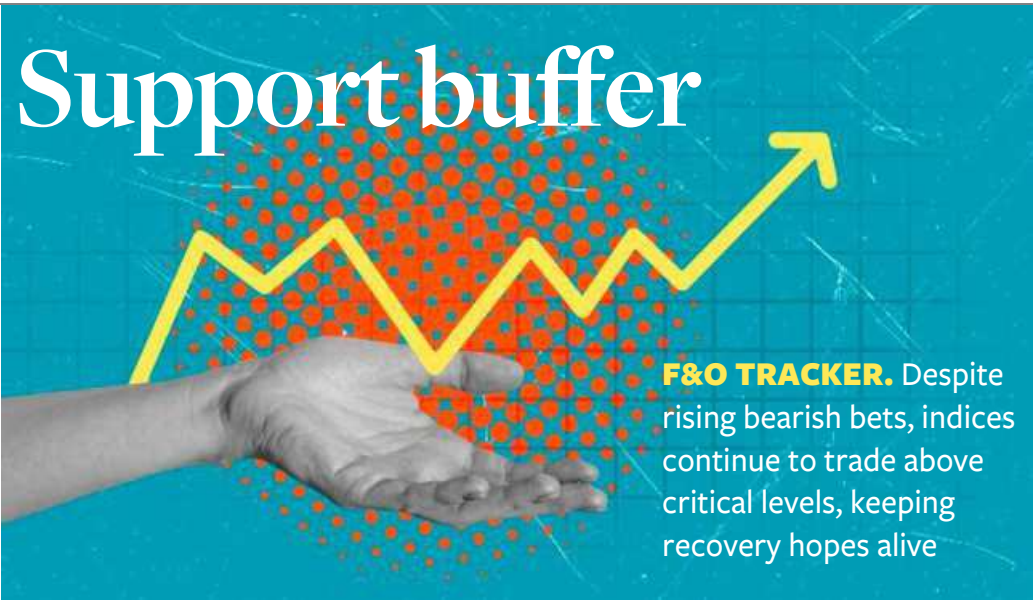
NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (May) (24,027) rallied in the first half of last week and hit a six-week high of 24,738.2 on Tuesday. However, the contract turned south and fell in the following sessions, losing 1.9 per cent for the week.

Nevertheless, the contract managed to close above the 24,000-mark. In fact, the outlook will turn bearish again only if May futures slips below the key support at 23,600.

We expect Nifty futures (May) to resume the rally either from the current level of 24,027 or it might see the correction extend to 23,600 and then establish the next uptrend. Once the rally re-starts, the contract can rise to 25,000.

However, if the support at 23,600 is breached, the immediate outlook can become bearish and Nifty futures (May) might decline to 23,000. Support below 23,000 is at 22,500.

Notably, as the May futures fell last week, the outstanding Open Interest (OI) of the contract tripled to nearly 77 lakh



F&O TRACKER. Despite rising bearish bets, indices continue to trade above critical levels, keeping recovery hopes alive

GETTY IMAGES

BROAD TREND

- Short build-up seen in May futures
- PCR diverges across indices
- Roll-over longs with strict stop-loss

contracts. This denotes short build-up.

But the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of April options stood at 1.1 on Friday. A ratio above 1 is because of selling of relatively greater number of puts when compared to calls, a positive sign.

Overall, certain elements of the data analysed point to weakness whereas the chart shows that key support levels are holding up well until now. Hence, traders ought to tread carefully.

Strategy: A couple of weeks ago, we had recommended buying Nifty futures (April) on a breakout of 24,200 with target and stop-loss at 25,000 and 23,800 respectively.

Since the April futures is nearing expiry, we suggest rolling over the longs to May futures exit the former now at 23,923 and buy the latter now at 24,027.

Taking into account the possibility of a deeper correction to 23,600 in May futures, we suggest placing stop-loss at 23,580. When the contract rises to 24,500 and 24,750, raise the stop-loss to 24,200 and 24,500 respectively. Exit at 25,000.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (May) (56,453) rose to mark a six-week

high of 57,889.60 last Wednesday before declining to end the week at 56,453 thereby posting a loss of 0.8 per cent.

But the bulls successfully defended the 56,250 support. The price band of 56,250-56,000 is a good base. Even if this level is taken out, for the trend to turn negative, Nifty Bank futures (May) must break down below 55,000.

We anticipate the recovery to happen anywhere within the broad price range of 55,000-56,250.

A potential upswing can then lift the contract to 59,000 quickly. A rally past 59,000 can lift it to 60,000.

On the contrary, if Nifty Bank futures (May) drops below the support at 55,000, it will open the door for a decline to 52,500 or even to 51,000.

The futures positioning supports the bearish bias as there has been short build-up last week i.e., as the May futures was down, the outstanding OI doubled to 10.6 lakh contracts.

Also, the PCR of May options stood at 0.90 on Friday. A ratio less than 1 is because of selling of relatively greater number of call options, a bearish signal.

While the futures and options data indicate weakness, the chart shows that certain key support levels are still valid and in fact, the recent price action suggests that Nifty Bank futures might rebound before Nifty futures.

Strategy: A couple of weeks or so ago, we had suggested buying Nifty Bank futures (April) on a breakout of 56,300. Recommended target and stop-loss levels were 59,000 and 55,000 respectively.

As the April contracts are set to expire on Tuesday, participants can roll-over the longs as the support levels have not given up yet. That is, exit April futures now at 56,207 and go long on May futures at the current market price of 56,453 with a stop-loss at 54,950.

When the contract rallies to 58,000, revise the stop-loss to 56,900. Book profits at 59,000.

Mind the margins

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Delivery margins will be levied on long call position 4 days before expiry

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

You must pay margins on your long equity call positions if the options are in-the-money (ITM) when they approach expiry. This week, we discuss how margins can affect your trading decision and how you can adjust your strategy accordingly.

MARGIN CALLS

If you initiate a long call position on an underlying, you must pay the premium upfront. Logically, you must have no further obligation. So, why does NSE levy margins on long positions on equity options? The reason is equity options are delivery-based. That is, if you hold ITM calls at expiry, you are required to take delivery. That means, you must have an amount equal to the permitted lot size times the strike price in your trading account. To ensure that you do not default on your payment at expiry, your broker will typically levy delivery margins on your long call position starting four days before expiry.

Now, traders do not want to take delivery of options for two



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

● **QUICK TIP**

Price of an ITM call at expiry is its intrinsic value, the difference between the underlying price and the strike price

reasons. One, the objective is to simply bet on an underlying's price movement, not buy the underlying. And two, traders want to avoid paying margins that progressively increase to 100 per cent on expiry day. This requires that you close your position well before expiry. How should you incorporate this into your trading decision?

It is typical to determine the

potential gains assuming your price target will be met at option expiry. This is because time value of an option is zero at expiry, making it easy to determine the price of the option for a given price target. Note that the price of an ITM call at expiry is its intrinsic value, the difference between the underlying price and the strike price. But you cannot hold the position till expiry if you want to avoid the progressively increasing delivery margins. Also, it will be incorrect to assume that the price target will be met well before expiry; that would create an upward bias, as potential gains will be higher as you will be able to recover some time value when you sell the op-

tion. What should you do? You should determine the likelihood of the underlying trading above the position's breakeven price before expiry. The breakeven price is the strike price plus the option price you pay to initiate the position. If that likelihood is high, you should consider initiating a long call position.

OPTIONAL READING

Determining the option price before expiry requires several assumptions that may be inaccurate. An optimal way would be to analyse the price charts to determine whether the underlying can move past the breakeven price. True, the reading of the price chart may not provide a timeline for the underlying to trade above the breakeven price. But the likelihood can be surmised based on the distance between current price and the breakeven price. Note that sooner the price moves above the breakeven price after your initiate the position, larger the gains.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Weak bias

BULLION CUES. Rebound likely later

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,709.80/ounce) snapped a three-week rally as it lost 2.5 per cent last week. During this period, silver (\$75.70/ounce), which gained for four weeks in a row, was down 6.3 per cent.

In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,52,699/10 gm) slipped 1.2 per cent and silver futures (₹2,44,636/kg) lost 4.9 per cent. Here is our analysis:

MCX-GOLD (₹1,52,699)

Gold futures (June), while posted a loss in the past week, gained 0.6 per cent on Friday, cutting the overall decline. Notably, the recovery on Friday happened on the back of the 21-day moving average (DMA).

However, for the contract to establish a sustainable rally, the resistance at ₹1,55,000 should be breached. Once this occurs, gold futures can rise to ₹1,63,000.

But if the decline continues this week, the price is likely to drop to ₹1,44,000. Given the current chart set-up, there is a chance for a moderation in price.



Trade strategy: Hold on to the short position we suggested at ₹1,54,000. But revise the stop-loss from ₹1,58,000 to ₹1,56,000. Retain target at ₹1,44,000.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,44,636)

Silver futures (May), despite the uptick on Friday, it lost 4.9 per cent last week.

The rebound occurred on the back of 21-DMA. But the outlook can turn positive only if the contract surpasses ₹2,60,000. In this case, it can go up to ₹2,80,000.

That said, the prevailing price action hints at some more downside, possibly to ₹2,30,000, before any possible recovery.

Trade strategy: Short silver futures at ₹2,50,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,30,000 and ₹2,60,000 respectively.

Broad range holds

CRUDE CHECK. Breakout to guide trend

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

After two weeks of fall, crude oil prices rose over the last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$99.13/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,817/barrel) were up 9.7 per cent and 15 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$99.13)

Brent crude oil futures, after opening with a gap-up, touched a two-week high of \$107.40 on Thursday before moderating to the current level of \$99.13.

The price action since mid-March shows that despite the volatility, Brent crude futures has largely stayed within the \$92-115 price band. Now at \$99, the contract can move either way.

In case the resistance at \$115 is breached, the contract can rise to \$130. But if it breaches the support at \$92, the downswing can extend to \$80.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹8,817)

Crude oil futures (May), like Brent crude futures, has been



trading in a broad range since mid-March. It has been oscillating within ₹7,800 and ₹9,500. Note that the 50-day moving average now coincides with ₹7,800, making it a good support.

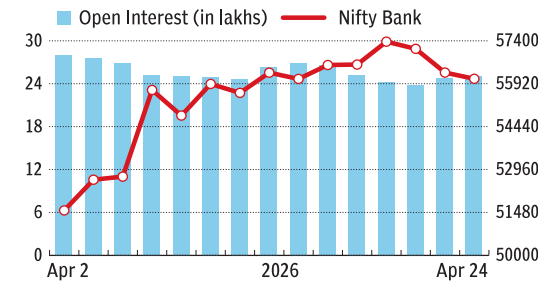
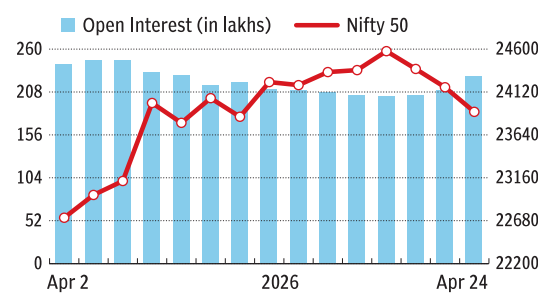
If the ongoing rally goes beyond the resistance at ₹9,500, it can open the door for an extension to ₹10,500 or even ₹11,000.

On the other hand, if crude oil futures drops below the support at ₹7,800, the near-term outlook can turn weak. In such a scenario, the contract can decline to ₹7,000. A breach of this can drag the contract further lower to ₹6,200.

Overall, as it stands, there is no clarity with respect to the trend for this week.

Trade strategy: Refrain from taking fresh trades.

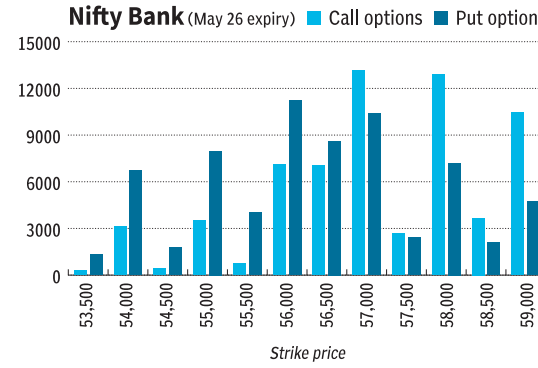
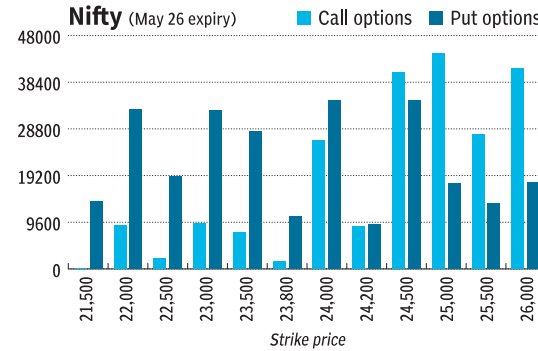
Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

(as on Apr 24)

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.08** | Nifty Bank **0.91**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Apr 24	Weekly change %	As on Apr 24	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	64025	-6	223706	4
Future Index Short	268104	4	85849	4
Net Futures	-204079	7	137857	5
Index Call options Long	658740	34	3167562	11
Index Call options Short	885490	40	3002126	6
Net Call options	-226750	61	165436	766
Index Put options Long	906190	6	2037739	-23
Index Put options Short	522378	-2	2771850	-11
Net Put Options	383812	19	-734111	65

FIIs increased net short on index futures as well as index call options. They also increased net long on puts. These are bearish indications.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Apr 24)				
TATAELXSI	4,193.00	-8.7	64.5	100.2
HCLTECH	1,203.20	-16.6	1103.2	97.3
HAVELLS	1,238.60	-5.2	280.9	94.4
OFSS	8,949.00	12.0	41.1	60.2
COCHINSHIP	1,664.70	6.6	56.1	55.1
FALL (as on Apr 24)				
ASTRAL	1,563.20	-2.6	162.4	-22.1
TATATECH	569.15	-3.4	84.8	-20.5
ANGELONE	314.52	-2.5	835.4	-19.7
HDFCAME	2,735.00	-2.1	87.7	-18.2
SWIGGY	287.10	3.5	600.9	-14.1

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Apr 27)

SAIL

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Apr 24)				
ALUMINIUM	29-May	374.2 (3.1)	2,354 (61)	Long build-up
COPPER	29-May	1,293.4 (0.4)	10,564 (64)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	18-May	8,817.0 (15.0)	11,003 (4)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	18-May	8,816.0 (15.1)	34,557 (28)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,52,699.0 (-1.2)	8,076 (-1)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	29-May	1,23,141.0 (-1.2)	11,492 (46)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Jun	1,52,764.0 (-1.2)	19,574 (26)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	29-May	15,425.0 (-1.2)	1,51,845 (35)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	29-May	1,53,002.0 (-1.4)	29,550 (37)	Short build-up
LEAD	29-May	199.3 (1.3)	239 (378)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	26-May	255.4 (-3.7)	26,323 (236)	Short build-up
SILVER	5-May	2,44,636.0 (-4.9)	4,829 (-16)	Long unwinding
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,52,994.0 (-4.3)	16,070 (115)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,53,025.0 (-4.3)	51,510 (101)	Short build-up
ZINC	29-May	349.5 (3.7)	1,549 (45)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Apr 24)				
USDINR	28-Apr	94.23 (1.3)	15,67,775 (-8)	Short covering
EURINR	28-Apr	110.33 (0.5)	28,086 (3)	Long build-up
GBPINR	28-Apr	127.17 (1.1)	24,843 (2)	Long build-up
JPYINR	28-Apr	58.94 (0.6)	102 (-19)	Short covering

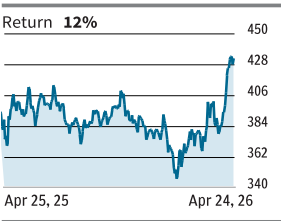
F&O Strategy

Buy Tata Power call

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for Tata Power Company (₹435) remains positive. The stock finds an immediate resistance at ₹460. If the current trend sustains, it can surpass ₹460 and hit a new high.

Immediate support is at ₹398 followed by a major one at ₹345. A close below the latter will alter the bullish view on the stock. But in the near-term we expect the current uptrend to continue.



F&O pointers: Tata Power April and May futures closed at ₹434.65 and ₹436.85 respectively against the spot price of ₹435. The counter witnessed a rollover of a healthy 58 per cent and premium in May futures signals the rollover is on the long side. Option trading indicates that the stock could move in the ₹415-460 range.

Strategy: Consider buying 440-call of May series. The option closed with a premium of ₹13.85 on Wednesday. As the market lot is 1,450 shares, this would cost traders ₹20,082.50. The maximum loss would be the premium paid (₹20,082.50) and that will happen if Tata Power fails to move above ₹440. The break-even point is ₹453.85.

We advise traders to keep the stop-loss at ₹8 initially. This can be shifted to ₹12.75 if the premium rises to ₹15. Traders can aim for a target of ₹18.

Follow-up: Suzlon remained resilient last week. Traders could consider holding the position with a stop-loss at ₹53.50.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

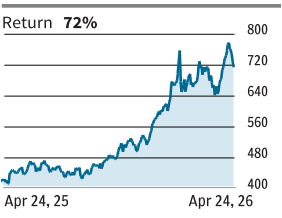
Vedanta F&O reset on demerger

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

Derivative contracts on Vedanta (₹720.95) will undergo a one-time adjustment following the company's scheme of arrangement (demerger). As per exchange circulars, all existing contracts, including those originally expiring in May, June and July, will be compulsorily brought forward and settled on April 29, 2026.

So, traders will not be able to carry positions beyond this date. All open derivative positions will cease to exist after final settlement and will result in physical delivery obligations.



The final settlement price will be based on the cash market closing price of Vedanta on April 29, while market-to-market (MTM) settlement will be completed on a T+1 basis (April 30).

Notably, the physical settlement arising from F&O positions will be netted with cash market obligations and settled through the normal market mechanism. In case a trader fails to deliver shares on the settlement day, the exchange will conduct an auction to procure the shares. If the shares are not available even in the auction, the position will be compulsorily cash-settled, usually at a penalty over the settlement price.

Post the corporate action, fresh derivative contracts will be reintroduced based on the adjusted price discovered in the special pre-open session on the ex-date (April 30).

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex tested their resistance and then fell back last week. This was in line with our expectation. Sensex and Nifty were down 2.33 per cent and 1.87 per cent respectively. The Nifty Bank index on the other hand fell 0.84 per cent.

A sharp fall in the Information Technology (IT) stocks weighed on the benchmark indices especially in the second half of the week. The BSE IT index tumbled about 10 per cent.

On the charts, the fall is just a correction within the recent up-move. Although there is room to fall further from here, supports are available to limit the downside. We can expect the Nifty and Sensex to rise back either from here or after some more fall. Nifty Bank index on the other hand has room to fall more before seeing a reversal.

FPIs SELL
Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold Indian equities last week. However, the quantum of selling was small. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$54 million.

NIFTY 50 (23,897.95)
Short-term view: Immediate support is at 23,800-23,750. Below that, the 23,600-23,500 region is the next key support. Nifty can reverse higher from either of these supports and go up to 24,700 again.

Failure to breach 24,700 can keep the index in a range of 23,500-24,700 for some time.

The bias remains positive. As such we can expect the Nifty to breach 24,700 if not immediately but eventually. Such a break can take the index higher to 25,300-25,500 in the short term.

Nifty will come under more pressure only if it breaks below 23,500. If that happens, then, there is a danger of revisiting 22,500 levels.

Medium-term view: There is no major change in the broader picture.

We retain our view of the Nifty targeting 26,500 in the medium term. Failure to breach 26,500 can keep the index in the broad range of 22,000-26,500 for some more time.

Eventually, Nifty is likely to break 26,500 and rally to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty declines



Limited downside

INDEX OUTLOOK. The fall last week is just a correction within the recent upmove

Nifty 50 gets a corrective fall



below 22,000.

NIFTY BANK (56,089.75)

Short-term view: There is room for a fall to 54,500 or 53,500 from here. But after this fall, the Nifty Bank index can reverse higher again. It can then go back up to 56,000 initially and to 58,000-58,500 eventually. An extended rise to 60,000 is also a possibility.

The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index breaks below 53,500. In that case, 52,500 and 51,000 can be seen on the downside.

Medium-term view: The bias remains positive. But we reiterate that a strong weekly close above 60,500 is needed to strengthen the bullish case. That in turn can boost the momentum and take the Nifty Bank index up to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term.

Such a rise will open the doors for the index to target 68,000-69,000 over the long term. Nifty

Bank index has to break below 50,000 to negate this bullish view.

SENSEX (76,664.21)

Short-term view: Support is at 76,000 which can be tested initially. The Sensex can rise back from there and go up to 77,300-77,350 initially.

A break above 77,350 will then ease the downside pressure and take the index up to 78,800-79,000 again. That in turn will increase the chances of a decisive break above 79,000 and a rise to 81,500-82,000.

A strong break below 76,000 is needed to bring the Sensex under pressure again. If it happens, then a fall to 74,000 and 72,500 is possible.

Medium-term view: The broader view remains positive. Sensex can gain momentum on a break above 83,000, a key intermediate resistance.

Such a break can take the index up to 86,000 in the medium

SUPPORTS TO WATCH

- Nifty 50: 23,800, 23,500
- Sensex: 76,000, 74,000
- Nifty Bank: 54,500, 53,500

term. An extended rise to 90,000 is also a possibility. In case the Sensex turns down from around 86,000, then it can remain stuck inside the broad range of 71,000-86,000 for some more time.

From a long-term perspective, the Sensex can target 98,000 on the upside. This will come into play once the index makes a decisive break above 86,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (21,875.95)

Barring the sharp fall on Friday, the Nifty Midcap 150 index remained higher and stable above 22,000.

Cluster of supports are there in the 21,630-21,560 region. A bounce from this support zone and a subsequent rise above 21,900 can take the index back up to 22,200.

An eventual break above 22,200 will then clear the way for the rise to 22,700-23,000.

The broader bias remains bullish.

A decisive break above 23,000 can strengthen the momentum. That in turn can trigger a fresh rally to 26,000-26,500 and 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

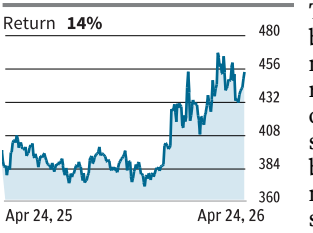
Crucial support to watch will be the 21,000-20,800 region.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

Coal India (₹455.85)

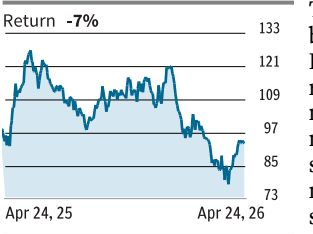
Resumption in uptrend



posted two consecutive weekly gains and the price has risen above both 21- and 50-day moving averages. As it stands, the likelihood of a rally has increased. Buy now at ₹455 and at ₹440. Keep stop-loss at ₹420. When the stock rises to ₹480, modify the stop-loss to ₹455. On a rally to ₹500, alter the stop-loss to ₹485. Exit at ₹525.

NBCC (India) (₹93.18)

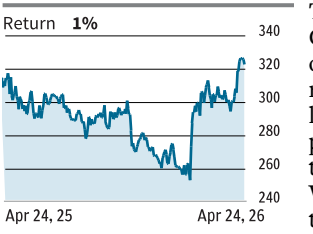
Potential shift in trend



of ₹90. We anticipate the scrip to pick up fresh positive momentum and appreciate to ₹115 over the next few months. So, buy now at ₹93 and add more longs if the price dips to ₹90. Initial stop-loss can be ₹84. When the stock touches ₹105, alter the stop-loss to ₹98. Raise the stop-loss to ₹105 when the price hits ₹110. Book profits at ₹115.

Power Grid Corporation of India (₹316.25)

Sees a fresh breakout



retest ₹305, we expect the stock to eventually resume the uptrend and rise to ₹360 over the coming months. Therefore, participants can consider buying the stock now at ₹316 and accumulate on a dip to ₹305. Place stop-loss at ₹280. When the price rises to ₹330, move the stop-loss to ₹315. On a rally to ₹350, revise the stop-loss to ₹340. Liquidate the longs at ₹360.

Bullish bias intact

US MARKET OUTLOOK. US bourses have room to rise more

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average snapped its three-week rally. The index was down 0.44 per cent. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index were up for the fourth consecutive week. S&P 500 was up marginally by 0.55 per cent. The NASDAQ Composite index on the other hand retained strength and rose 1.5 per cent last week.

Broadly, the picture continues to remain positive for the US benchmark indices. They can rise more in the coming weeks.

DOW JONES (49,230.71)

The price action on the daily chart indicates lack of strong sellers in the market. That keeps intact the broader bullish bias. Immediate support is in the 48,950-48,900 region. Below that, 48,400-48,300 is the next important support which can be tested if the Dow declines below 48,900. However, a fall beyond 48,300 is unlikely.

A bounce either from 48,900 itself or from around 48,300 can take the Dow up to 49,900-50,000 again. An eventual break above 50,000 can then clear the way for a further rise to 51,000-52,000.

The outlook will turn negative only if the Dow breaks below 48,300. If that happens, a fall to 46,000-45,000 can be seen.

S&P 500 (7,165.08)

The index is getting good buyers below 7,100. That leaves the chances high for the index to breach 7,200. Such a break can boost the momentum and take the S&P 500 up to 7,600 in the coming weeks.

To negate this rise, the index has to sustain below 7,200 and break below 7,100 decisively. Only then a fall to 7,000 and lower levels will come into the picture.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (24,836.60)

The index has sustained well



GETTY IMAGES

SUPPORT HOLDS

The US 10Yr is holding well above 4.25 per cent and can rise to 4.5-4.6 per cent on a break above 4.35 per cent

above the 24,000-23,950 levels and saw a very good follow-through rise last week. This strengthens the bullish case. NASDAQ Composite index can rally to 26,300-26,500 in the coming weeks.

To negate this bullish view, the index has to decline below 24,000. Only then a fall to 23,000-22,500 will come into the picture. But such a fall looks unlikely, as seen from the chart. Also, a strong negative trigger might be needed now to drag the index below 24,000.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (98.50) managed to bounce back after witnessing a sharp fall for two weeks. Immediate support will be at 98.30. Below that, 98 and 97.70 are the next strong supports.

Resistance is in the 99-99.20 region. A strong break above 99.20 is needed to go up to 99.50. This level of 99.50 is an important resistance. The dollar index has to breach this hurdle to gain strength. That will then

open the doors for a rise to 100.50-101 eventually.

For now, the immediate picture is slightly unclear. We can expect a broad range of 97.70-99.50 for some time. The bias is, however, positive to see a bullish breakout above 99.50 eventually.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.31 per cent) managed to sustain above 4.25 per cent and has risen last week. This has reduced the chances of the fall to 4.15-4.1 per cent mentioned last week. Immediate support is at 4.28 per cent, and then, 4.25 per cent will continue to act as a strong support.

The bias is positive to break the resistance at 4.35 per cent and rise to 4.5-4.6 per cent in the coming weeks.

The US 10Yr Yield has to break 4.25 per cent to come under pressure for a fall to 4.15 per cent.

FED WATCH

The US Federal Reserve meeting outcome is due on Wednesday. The interest rate is likely to be kept unchanged at 3.5-3.75 per cent. As such this can largely be a non-event for the market. However, it will be important to see the central bank's comments on the impact of the on-going US-Iran war.

TECH QUERY



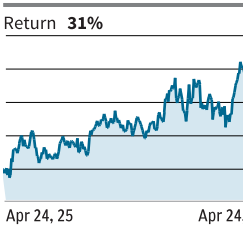
GURUMURTHY K

bl. research bureau

I have NMDC shares. My purchase price is ₹65. What is the long-term outlook?

Sharad S Chandak, Bhopal

NMDC (₹89): The outlook is bullish. Strong support is in the ₹72-70 region. The stock has potential to target ₹125 in a year or so. This rise may happen at a gradual



pace also. So, you need to have patience to hold this stock. Keep a stop-loss at ₹69 now so that you can protect some profit. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹81 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹92. Revise the stop-loss further higher to ₹95 and ₹110 when the

price touches ₹107 and ₹118 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹125. In the past, there has been a sharp fall every time the stock goes up to ₹130. So, you will have to exit at ₹125 rather than becoming more greedy at that point of time.

What is the outlook for IDBI Bank? Is it a good time to enter this stock now?

Rahamath M, Coimbatore

IDBI Bank (₹76): After tumbling over 47 per cent last month, the stock is struggling to recover. The recent bounce seems to lack strength. For now, it looks like



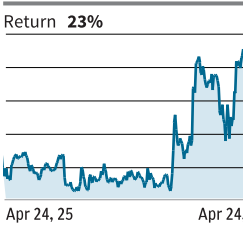
one more leg of fall to ₹62 or even ₹56 is possible. If the price falls from here, then you can buy at ₹64 and ₹58. Keep the stop-loss at ₹38. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹74 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹92. Move the stop-loss further up to ₹88 and ₹104 when the price touches ₹102 and

₹125 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹145. This rise to ₹145 can take a very long time. May be two years or even more. So, you will need a lot of patience if you decide to take this trade.

I have shares of GNA Axles bought around ₹320. What are the prospects? Kindly advise.

Navendu Sharma, Patna

GNA Axles (₹429): The broader picture is positive. A possible cup and handle pattern is forming on the chart. A short-term dip to ₹390 is a possibility. Cluster of



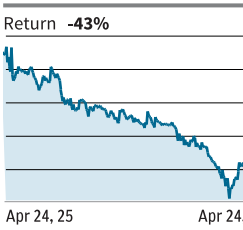
supports are there in the ₹390 and ₹360 region which can limit the downside. Resistance is around ₹470 which is holding well for now. The stock can break this resistance if not immediately but eventually. Such a break

can take GNA Axles share price higher to ₹625 in the long term. Keep a stop-loss at ₹345 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹420 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹480. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹490 and ₹540 when the price touches ₹530 and ₹590 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹610.

I have bought Ganesh Housing at ₹910, What is the outlook? Can I continue to hold?

Patchaiyappan, Chennai

Ganesh Housing (₹643): The stock is in a strong downtrend since February last year. The recent bounce from around ₹503 looks just like a corrective rise. A



crucial resistance is around ₹700. Failure to rise past this hurdle can drag the share price down to ₹450 in the coming months. In case the stock manages to breach ₹700, an extended rise to ₹800-830 can be seen. It is better to exit the

stock and accept the loss rather than waiting with a hope for the price to rise. Always remember to have a stop-loss at the time of entering any trade. All the more important is strictly adhering to the stop-loss. This will help you come out of any wrong trade with minimum loss.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

- 1 Oracle Financial Services**
- 2 Adani Green Energy**
- 3 United Spirits**
- 4 Coal India**
- 5 Aster DM Healthcare**

Last week's prize winner
Kalyan Banerjee

Last week's winning stock
Finolex Cables

Closing price
(Apr 17)
₹943.60

Closing price
(Apr 24)
₹973.05

Return:
3.12 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 2.3 and 1.9 per cent respectively last week. BSE Power gained the most by 3.7 per cent, followed by BSE FMCG 2.1 per cent and BSE Capital Goods 1.3 per cent. BSE IT and BSE Teck declined the most by 9.9 and 7.6 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Y-High	Y-Low	
360 One [1]	1039.4	29.9	34.7	4.3	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	-6.5	14.3	2.0	1273.0	861.8	
3M India	3263.2	542.7	60.1	17.1	202606	0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	3.9	19.8	0.0	3830.0	2830.0	
A B B [2]	7327.0	78.8	93.0	19.8	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	4.2	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5	
A B Real Estate	4460.0	-19.0		4.2	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.6	-0.2	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	1491.9	23.9	20.4	3.1	202512	18.2	-22.7	18.7	20.0	-1.6	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2	
Aarti Industries [5]	472.3	10.2	46.2	3.0	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	7.2	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2	
AARTIS Industries	1411.2	61.8	22.8	3.0	202403	21.4	23.5	25.4	14.2	4.7	9.9	3.2	2165.0	1500.5	
Abbott India	25198.5	717.3	35.1	13.4	202512	8.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	-2.3	45.0	0.0	35992.6	21567.1	
ACC	1411.6	134.0	10.5	1.3	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	-1.4	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1250.0	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	305.4	8.3	36.9	3.9	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	0.1	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7	
Action Const.Eng.	906.7	35.5	25.5	6.1	202512	1.2	4.2	3.3	4.2	3.3	8.6	-1.1	44.02	0.3900	746.5
Adani Energy Sol.	1412.4	19.0	74.3	6.7	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	12.2	10.1	0.2	1425.0	745.5	
Adani Enterp. [1]	1286.7	25.5	89.7	5.5	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	3.1	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1753.7	
Adani Green	1235.2	11.2	110.1	10.2	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	9.6	9.4	0.4	152.8	767.0	
Adani Ports [2]	1585.9	54.8	28.9	4.3	202512	21.9	24.3	26.3	18.9	0.8	14.0	0.9	1617.4	1181.7	
Adani Power [2]	213.1	5.9	35.9	7.0	202512	18.9	-1.9	12.7	10.1	21.4	21.2	0.7	173.1	101.1	
Adani Total Gas [1]	627.0	5.8	107.4	15.3	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	-0.9	17.4	0.4	797.4	453.5	
Aditya AMC [5]	160.9	3.38	31.6	7.6	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	-0.4	35.5	0.0	109.8	611.8	
Aditya Bkr. Fint.	61.9	-6.2	1.2	202512	17.9	-215.9	9.7	4.5	-3.6	0.0	1.3	17.7	0.0	53.6	
Aegis Birla Cap.	340.2	13.5	25.1	2.8	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.2	0.5	9.4	4.4	369.3	186.0	
Aegis Logistics [1]	714.7	21.9	32.6	4.2	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	0.8	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0	
Aether Industries [1]	1114.1	16.9	66.1	6.4	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	-5.6	9.7	0.1	1250.0	723.2	
Affcons Infrastr.	315.1	13.9	22.7	2.2	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	-5.7	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.9	
Affle B [2]	1407.3	31.1	45.2	6.1	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	-4.1	16.6	0.1	2186.1	1251.9	
Aija Engineering [2]	401.8	124.8	32.2	5.1	202512	-0.1	17.6	-2.6	10.3	1.5	32.1	0.1	4200.0	3006.6	
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2767.2	81.2	34.1	8.0	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	-0.8	32.0	0.0	3158.2	2335.0	
Alcembic Pharma [2]	751.1	33.8	22.3	2.8	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	-4.3	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.3	
Alkem Lab [2]	548.8	20.9	46.0	4.7	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	8.7	4.4	20.4	0.0	593.0	471.8	
Alkyl Amines [2]	1476.6	35.3	41.8	5.2	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	2.9	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4	
Allied Blenders [2]	557.3	9.6	58.1	10.0	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	-2.8	21.0	0.9	72.0	302.5	
Alok Industries [1]	13.5	-1.6		-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	-5.5	0.0	0.0	23.5	11.1	
Aloks Engrs. [1]	880.5	37.4	23.5	5.5	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	13.1	15.6	0.0	109.9	671.5	
Amber Entrep.	7748.5	66.0	117.3	7.5	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	-2.7	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0	
Amul Cement [2]	450.7	15.6	28.9	2.0	202512	9.2	-89.9	16.4	-8.7	-1.2	12.7	0.0	626.0	250.0	
Anand Rathn Wea. [5]	3579.4	10.7	35.1	29.8	202603	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	-0.7	56.8	0.1	3733.9	1636.8	
Anand Wea. [1]	462.1	14.6	31.6	3.0	202512	10.9	0.1	74.1	40.3	30.8	12.9	0.0	369.3	186.0	
Angel One [1]	314.8	10.0	31.7	4.7	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-2.7	25.8	0.7	330.1	208.9	
Apar Inds.	11541.3	246.9	46.8	9.6	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	0.6	32.6	0.1	12325.0	5300.5	
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2004.3	41.1	48.7	12.1	202512	7.2	42.9	9.2	80.0	-4.8	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0	
APL Apollo Tubes	772.7	16.8	61.2	12.2	202512	37.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	0.3	17.5	0.6	809.0	680.0	
Apollo Tyres [1]	424.6	23.0	18.5	1.7	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	4.7	10.9	0.3	600.3	392.3		
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	254.5	17.8	14.3	2.7	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	0.2	15.1	0.5	364.9	193.5	
Asahi India Glas [1]	835.0	12.3	67.9	5.8	202512	8.4	32.8	5.3	4.7	-1.9	13.1	0.9	1073.0	680.0	
Ashtek Leyland [1]	169.9	6.2	27.5	7.9	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-2.8	14.9	4.3	215.6	143.0	
Ashtek Paints [1]	2484.4	12.3	228.0	11.5	202512	22.5	18.2	-16.0	-9.9	0.7	18.1	0.0	2885.2	2116.0	
Aster DM Health.	705.4	7.0	100.6	8.7	202512	12.9	-10.1	8.5	38.5	2.5	11.6	0.5	732.0	492.7	
Astral [1]	1562.4	19.2	81.5	11.1	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	-3.1	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1240.5	
Azarcemchem Phar [2]	689.2	12.0	29.2	26.6	202512	16.2	18.5	25.5	24.1	-0.7	32.0	0.0	10653.1	7630.0	
Ather Energy [1]	88.5	-16.9		-0.3	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	25.0	3.7	0.0	0.0	940.0	527.9	
Atul	692.2	23.0	29.1	3.2	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	1.5	12.8	0.0	779.0	583.0	
AU Small Finance	1065.6	30.9	34.5	4.4	202512	14.9	26.3	23.2	13.6	7.5	0.0	0.0	1079.7	655.0	
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1413.8	60.8	23.3	2.3	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-2.0	14.2	0.2	1459.8	1017.0	
Aurobindo Invest [1]	488.0	42.8	11.4	2.6	202512	-22.5	18.2	-16.0	-9.9	0.7	18.1	0.0	683.5	455.0	
Avanti Supergr.	4446.2	43.9	101.2	12.7	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	-4.0	18.8	0.0	4916.3	3528.7	
AWL Agrul Busine. [1]	197.8	7.4	26.8	2.6	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	6.9	19.0	0.3	287.0	171.2	
Axis Bank [2]	1366.1	84.9	16.1	2.1	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	0.5	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3	

B H E L [2]	337.4	2.3	144.3	4.8	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	6.5	3.2	0.4	391.0	205.2
B PCL [1]	308.1	57.6	5.3	1.4	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	-1.3	15.7	0.7	341.0	266.6
Bajaj Auto [2]	9976.1	29.9	29.8	17.7	202512	15.6	44.7	21.0	18.1	0.0	2.0	161.0	755.1	
Bajaj Finance [1]	921.5	29.3	31.5	5.6	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	1.4	11.4	3.8	1102.5	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1770.4	62.1	28.5	3.7	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	-3.7	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [2]	10272.9	660.2	15.6	1.7	202512	127.6	15.5	-34.1	-12.2	-0.9	11.5	0.0	10478.2	8597.5
Bajaj Housing	275.0	12.0	22.9	3.5	202512	18.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	-2.7	9.5	4.7	317.0	172.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2321.2	67.9	32.9	4.1	202512	6.9	-15.0	-2.6	-26.0	-4.2	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2016.0
Balrampur Chini [1]	515.7	22.2	23.2	2.7	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	6.1	11.1	0.6	127.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank [1]	174.6	6.3	27.9	1.1	202512	-0.9	51.8	0.0	59.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	92.5	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	374.2	27.6	7.3	0.9	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.7	-1.0	0.0	0.0	325.6	212.1
Bank of India [2]	147.4	22.6	6.6	0.9	202512	10.0	6.7	7.9	-19.7	-0.5	0.0	0.0	17.8	104.1
Bank of Maha [1]	77.9	9.1	8.5	1.9	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	7.2	0.0	0.0	82.2	47.1
BASF India [1]	3649.2	84.3	43.3	4.2	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	-1.5	17.9	0.1	5418.2	3960.0
Bata India [5]	737.3	14.9	49.4	6.2	202512	2.8	0.9	-0.6	23.4	-2.6	14.6	0.9	130.0	605.6
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	144.7	14.2	10.4	1.4	202512	4.6	17.9	7.7	28.7	-4.5	23.8	0.0	650.0	427.9
BEML Ltd [5]	1792.2	29.9	59.9	5.3	202512	23.7	191.7	8.4	-4.8	1.2	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	460.8	9.6	47.9	8.6	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	-1.7	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1399.9	15.8	88.5	12.2	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	1.4	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0
Bharat Electronics [1]	444.7	8.8	24.5	15.1	202512	26.0	20.3	14.5	19.5	-3.9	36.9	3.2	219.9	233.7
Bharat Forge [2]	185.6	24.4	75.9	9.5	202512	25.0	41.3	4.5	18.2	-0.2	11.7	0.9	193.6	107.1
Bharti Airtel [5]	1814.7	50.4	36.0	9.4	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.0	-1.7	14.3	2.2	2147.4	1747.2
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1532.7	35.2	43.5	12.3	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	-0.4	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.6
Bharat Sanjiv [1]	659.1	10.0	66.3	11.0	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	-0.1	18.4	0.2	820.9	591.7
Biocon [1]	59.1	5.1	69.2	1.5	202512	9.3	1733.6	14.4	5.9	-2.4	6.9	0.8	425.0	378.0
Birla Corpn.	908.5	74.2	12.2	1.1	202512	-4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	-6.8	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	368.7	17.5	21.1	2.8	202512	-1.1	22.7	-2.6	-15.1	-5.6	10.8	0.0	723.8	422.0
Birla Sun Life [1]	171.6	1.1	17.6	1.1	202512	1.6	4.4	4.7	-4.7	-1.0	0.0	0.0	17.6	10.0
Blue Bird Express	5345.2	125.2	43.6	7.8	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	5.7	-1.7	17.1	0.7	722.4	418.5
Blue Dart International	406.1	13.9	29.9	2.0	202512	1.6	20.6	20.4	20.4	0.0	0.0	0.0	406.1	206.0
Blue Star [2]	1817.8	26.0	69.9	12.0	202512	4.2	-2.0	9.5	-2.6	-2.5	0.1	20.5	1450.0	1450.0
Boch	36681.0	783.8	46.8	7.7	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	-2.2	20.5	0.0	0.0	0.0
Brainbuses Soluit. [2]	244.1	-3.0	2.7	202512	11.6	17.2	12.4	-3.4	-3.3	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.0	
Bridge Tech [1]	76.6	1.3	25.0	1.0	202512	1.2	12.3	-1.3	-2.0	-0.1	0.0	0.0	76.6	37.0
Britannia Inds [1]	5732.4	100.3	2.7	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	0.0	51.9	0.4	0.3	730.7	5280.0

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Health insurance can be a useful tool, but sometimes it can miss the most basic things. Critical diseases, hospitalisation, transplants and even expensive diagnostics can be covered by health insurance. That said, there are aspects where health insurance can be restrictive. Cataract is one such issue.

Cataract predominantly affects the aged. In one study conducted in India, cataract was found to be prevalent in close to 60 per cent of patients over the age of 60. If left untreated, the condition can lead to severe visual impairment, and even blindness. Cataract can be aggravated by diabetes. With India facing a high incidence of diabetes, the risk of cataract impacting the elderly is significantly higher in the country. The high incidence may partly explain why insurers often impose tighter coverage conditions. Because cataract is common and often age-related, insurers tend to impose tighter limits and waiting periods.

The key limits on cataract coverage are outlined here. Alongside, we cite comments by Siddharth Singhal, Head of Health Insurance at Policy-bazaar, on the concerns, and a few ways by which these can be checked.

COVERAGE

The basic restriction pertains to the waiting period. Most policyholders would be aware of the pre-existing waiting period or PED which generally is three years for most policies. But, cataract coverage falls under the lesser-known ‘specific disease’ waiting period of two years. Generally, slow-growing diseases fall under this category including, not just cataract but also, pancreatitis, cirrhosis, osteoarthritis, and knee replace-



POLICY-WISE. Cataract, with higher incidence among the elderly, has restrictive coverage in health insurance

GETTY IMAGES

ment. Even if a policyholder is not impacted by the disease at the time of policy issuance, the coverage for these diseases will start only after two years of continuous policy cover. If the sum insured is raised, this two-year waiting period will be applicable to the incremental amount. However, in case of porting a policy, the period served carries over just as with PED waiting period.

In addition to the waiting period, which is present in most of the policies, monetary restriction too is a hurdle and can take several forms.

Firstly, many newer policies issued in the last couple of years do not mention any form of sub-limits for cataract coverage. Not only cataract, but room rent, disease sub-limits, day care procedures, do not face sub-limits in these policies. This could also be attributed to sum insured be-

OVERVIEW

- ‘Specific disease’ waiting period of 2 years
- Monetary restriction can be a hurdle
- Newer policies do not have sub-limits

ing ₹10 lakh or higher in these policies.

Policyholders are recommended to read the fine print in the customer information sheet and policy wording. Even after the purchase, there is a 15-day free-look period during which the policy can be reviewed and cancelled if the terms do not match what was promised. On the other hand, policyholders who bought insurance earlier may have sub-limits on cataract. The most common sub-limit pre-

scribes an amount of ₹20,000-50,000 for cataract procedure on a single eye. Compared with an average cost of ₹50,000-60,000 per eye for cataract procedure, this sub-limit protects the policyholder only to an extent.

For one of Star Health’s insurance plans, the policy prescribes ₹30,000 per eye per person and does not exceed ₹40,000 per policy period for a cataract procedure. Some policies set the sub-limit for cataract surgery at 10 to 25 per cent of the sum insured along with a maximum cap of ₹20,000-50,000 per eye.

Some insurance policies, such as Niva Bupa for instance, prescribe providing cover for monofocal lens for the treatment of cataract.

The treatment for cataract often involves monofocal lens at the lower end of cost or multifocal at the higher end of cost.

The range can be ascribed to medical necessity or lifestyle choices. As insurance covers only medically necessary costs, the latter are generally not covered.

Siddharth Singhal, Head of Health Insurance at Policy-bazaar, mentions as cataract is a slowly advancing disease, insurance companies can place a two-year waiting period for coverage.

But he says most of the monetary sub-limits are being done away with. He suggested a rider that shortens the waiting period (both PED and slow-growing disease waiting period) as a measure to improve utilisation of health insurance policies.

Policyholders facing a slew of sub-limits mostly found in older policies including cataract, may consider porting to a new policy which has mostly done away with sub-limits on most issues.

SIMPLYPUT.

Brent crude: Spot realities vs futures pricing

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Two friends get into a discussion about the crude realities of oil pricing

Praveen: While reading the news a few days ago, I came to know that the Dated Brent price touched an all-time high of \$145 a barrel. It felt odd. As I’ve been tracking oil price since the US-Iran war began, I knew very well that crude was trading just under \$100. I checked on Google to make sure, and crude was trading at only \$96 a barrel. What is this ‘Dated Brent’ and why is its price different?

Naveen: What you checked on Google is the futures price of Brent crude and what was reported in the news is the price of Dated Brent, which represents the actual price refiners are paying for oil in the physical world — also known as spot market price. This Dated Brent price is also the primary global benchmark for physical oil trades.

Brent as you would know is a grade of light crude oil extracted in the North Sea that is easy to refine, but, would you like to know why it’s called ‘Dated’?

Praveen: Yes, I’m all ears.

Naveen: You see, crude is transported by oil tankers around the world, and is loaded on to them at a place called the ‘loading terminal’.

Based on availability, the terminal operator would give a 3-day loading window/slot to the oil producer.

During these days, the oil buyer has to send a ship to collect the oil. This dating process is by which it came to be known as ‘Dated Brent’. There is one more nuance I would like you to know. Today, Dated Brent is at \$113. What this represents is the price of oil that will be loaded on to a tanker (at a terminal) 10-30 days from today, and from there delivered at a later date at the buyer’s location. It is not the price of oil being delivered today.

Praveen: Why is it so?

Naveen: Once the seller notifies the loading window dates to the buyer, the buyer will certainly need some time to charter a vessel, arrange insurance and so on. This 10-30-day time-gap is to let the buyer arrange these.

Praveen: I see. Now tell me how I can check this Dated Brent price.

Naveen: Unlike Brent futures which are traded on exchanges, Dated Brent is not, and is instead an assessment made



by agencies such as Platts (S&P) and Argus Media.

These are not available freely in public sites unless reported in the media.

Praveen: Why was Dated Brent at \$145, when futures were trading at \$96?

Naveen: Here some nuances must be understood. The \$96 a barrel you mentioned — that’s actually the price of June ICE (Intercontinental Exchange) Brent futures in early April. These futures, are just paper trades settled in cash and entail no physical delivery of crude (unless coupled with EFP-discussed here). These primarily serve as a tool for price discovery and are used for hedging and speculation alike. June futures were at least 70-80 days out in the future, while Dated Brent captured prices of crude that would be loaded on to tankers in the next 10-30 days and thereby, those transactions close by mid-May latest.

With a lower price than the spot market benchmark, the futures market expected the acute oil deficit to ease substantially by June. That’s the interpretation for the difference that you asked.

Praveen: Interesting. But this is my understanding of futures. Futures are basically derivatives deriving their value from the underlying. Crude is the underlying here. Shouldn’t they move in tandem with the physical market? Won’t such a large gap between futures and

spot price give rise to massive arbitrages?

Naveen: Futures eventually have to converge with physical prices and there are three ways this could happen.

But before that, bear with me as I take you on a little detour to the forward market. While the futures market is meant for financial or mere cash-settled trades, the forward market is meant for traders who want to take/give physical delivery of crude. Here, the 25-day BFOET forward market happens to be the benchmark and a reference for Dated Brent prices as well. BFOET refers to North Sea crude grades namely, Brent, Forties, Oseberg, Ekofisk and Troll. The ‘25-day’ period refers to a mandatory 25-day notice a seller of the forward has to give the buyer before the first day of the 3-day loading window. Again, this is to let the buyer arrange logistics.

The front month forward contract as of today, is the June forward. June, here, refers to the delivery month or the month in which crude will be loaded on to a tanker.

However, trading for June forward expires by the end of April itself! This is so structured to accommodate the 25-day notice period, even for contracts struck in the end of April. May will serve as the gap month for the June forward.

When April ends and rolls over to May, the delivery month also rolls a month forward to

July — meaning, for contracts traded in May, deliveries will happen in July, so on and so forth.

With me so far?

Praveen: Oh yeah. Now tell me how the convergence happens between futures and spot price, in the three ways you mentioned.

Naveen: The first is through an exchange settlement mechanism. In case of futures traders on ICE who hold their positions open until expiry, the exchange will publish the ICE Brent Index on the business day following the expiry day and this is the price such traders have to use to square off their positions. For instance, in case of June futures, the expiry day will fall on April 30, and ICE Brent index value will be published on May 1.

Praveen: Got it. So, how does this index help futures and spot prices converge?

Naveen: The answer lies in the index’s methodology. It’s a bit complex but you can understand that the index largely derives its value from the forward market, I told you about.

For example, ICE Brent index for June futures (April expiry) will largely derive its value from the prices of June forward contracts. As we near April-end, the prevailing Dated Brent and forward prices will have a bearing on this index. The index, thus deriving its value, aids the futures market converge with the spot market.

Look at it this way. There is a

futures market which involves financial speculators. There is a physical market that involves taking delivery, reflecting real demand and supply. These tend to converge as we near expiry.

Praveen: Understood. What are the other two ways?

Naveen: The second way addresses your question about arbitrages. When traders spot large differences between the futures and physical forward market prices, they buy the undervalued futures and simultaneously sell a forward (which trade higher) in the physical market. Now, there is a derivative instrument called EFP (exchange for physical) which lets a futures trader swap his paper long futures position for a physical long forward contract, but at a swap cost. The trader can then square the long and short physical forward positions and pocket the gain (cash settled in general, as these are essentially arbitrage trades). However, when arbitrage windows emerge, traders flock to buy futures in large quantities — thus taking futures price closer to that of physical forwards.

The third way involves a short squeeze.

Traders holding short positions in the futures market face risk of losses if the physical market disconnects to the upside, making no sense to hold on till expiry. When a large population of such traders buy futures to cover their shorts, it triggers a short squeeze, pushing futures price closer to physical market price.

Praveen: I see. You mentioned Dated Brent is at \$113 today, having fallen from \$145 a couple weeks ago. What explains this?

Naveen: A reason why this could be so is that since the ceasefire was announced, military attacks have largely stopped and that could’ve helped spot prices cool. However, the ongoing blockade, production shut-ins in West Asian countries and depletion of high sea inventory haven’t yet eased the flow of crude. Despite this, spot prices have fallen. There could be one possible explanation — demand destruction i.e., demand for crude is coming down due to high prices.

Praveen: That is bad news for economic activity and the stock markets, isn’t it?

Naveen: Possibly. That makes it all the more important for investors to keep a close eye on this interplay of crude futures and the physical market.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Mar 25
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Apr 23
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.9	6.6	6.2	6	Apr 20
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Apr 24
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Apr 15
DCB Bank	6.5	7.15	7.15	7.15	Mar 19
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Apr 24
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.4	7	7	Mar 19
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.75	6.15	6.15	Apr 11
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Apr 22
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Apr 09
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	8	7.25	6	Mar 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.5	7.5	7.77	Apr 11
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

Data as on respective banks’ website on 24 Apr 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

Bajaj Life Care Plus Rider

Bajaj Life Insurance has introduced Bajaj Life Care Plus Rider, an industry-first solution that offers living benefits across health, wellness, and fitness with life insurance policies. Available with eligible life insurance plans, the rider offers five variants Prime, Pro, Ultra, Prestige, and Optima, allowing customers to choose an option aligned with their lifestyle and financial protection needs. The rider goes beyond traditional riders by offering a comprehensive solution that combines health and mental well-being with financial safeguards, with living benefits worth up to ₹2,00,000 per annum at ₹1,911 per month.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5 [#]	7.5 [#]	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India



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bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.1	15235	1.7	0.6	-1.5	13.3	11.9	13.5	0.33
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	106.7	69948	1.4	0.9	0.6	15.9	15.3	14.1	0.49
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	88.9	46521	1.5	0.7	3.0	17.2	17.7	14.6	0.54
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1095.0	35458	1.6	1.0	-1.4	13.3	14.3	13.0	0.43
*****	JM Large Cap	148.1	390	2.4	0.9	0.6	13.9	12.7	11.0	0.34
*****	Kotak Large Cap	554.4	9794	1.7	0.6	1.1	13.7	12.6	12.6	0.35
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.3	48926	1.5	0.8	2.8	12.8	12.5	12.3	0.36
****	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	503.5	26702	1.6	1.0	-0.7	13.6	12.9	12.2	0.36
****	Bandhan Large Cap	75.2	1821	2.1	0.9	2.3	15.4	13.2	12.7	0.36
****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	215.4	2344	2.0	0.8	1.4	14.7	13.3	12.6	0.37
****	Edelweiss Large Cap	81.3	1322	2.1	0.6	-0.1	13.1	12.5	12.7	0.35
****	Franklin Ind Large Cap	987.9	6821	1.9	1.2	0.5	13.0	11.1	10.9	0.31
****	Invesco India Largecap	67.5	1537	2.0	0.7	2.2	16.5	14.3	12.8	0.39
****	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.3	35343	1.5	0.6	0.2	11.6	11.1	12.9	0.30
****	Tata Large Cap	495.9	2448	2.0	1.0	1.9	13.8	13.1	12.0	0.36
****	UTI Large Cap	258.0	11203	1.8	0.9	-2.9	11.1	10.3	11.5	0.27
***	DSP Large Cap	450.5	6620	1.8	0.9	-3.4	15.4	12.7	11.6	0.38
***	HSBC Large Cap	464.3	1667	2.2	1.3	1.4	13.8	12.1	12.4	0.31
***	LIC MF Large Cap	52.4	1253	2.2	1.1	-3.8	10.2	9.7	10.4	0.23
***	Union Largecap	22.7	403	2.6	1.8	0.0	11.8	11.3	-	0.29
***	Axis Large Cap	57.5	28661	1.6	0.7	-2.7	10.9	8.8	11.8	0.19
***	Groww Largecap	42.0	117	2.5	1.3	3.5	13.0	11.6	11.1	0.30
***	PGIM India Large Cap	323.7	503	2.4	0.9	-1.6	9.7	9.1	10.2	0.22
***	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.9	651	2.4	0.8	-3.0	12.4	11.4	-	0.31
-	Taurus Large Cap	155.2	46	2.6	2.3	2.1	14.9	12.6	10.5	0.32

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	136.4	14109	1.7	0.5	7.2	23.5	19.5	16.2	0.56
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	330.4	25295	1.6	0.9	2.3	18.6	18.1	14.7	0.52
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1003.2	27005	1.6	0.8	4.1	20.2	19.9	15.8	0.65
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.8	13973	1.7	0.6	6.6	19.1	15.3	-	0.39
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	114.8	2782	2.0	0.8	1.3	17.3	17.1	15.8	0.42
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	628.4	34871	1.6	0.7	6.9	16.8	17.1	15.0	0.53
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	179.2	5234	1.8	0.9	4.4	20.7	18.1	14.4	0.55
****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	89.1	422	2.3	1.1	6.8	16.8	15.4	12.9	0.42
****	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	243.8	22203	1.6	0.7	-0.8	15.6	13.9	15.2	0.37
****	DSP Large & Mid Cap	608.6	15780	1.7	0.7	1.4	19.2	16.0	15.1	0.46
****	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	87.0	4067	1.9	0.5	6.6	18.4	15.8	14.7	0.43
****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	99.0	8436	1.8	0.6	7.3	24.4	18.5	16.1	0.45
****	Kotak Large & Midcap	342.8	27373	1.6	0.6	6.6	18.3	16.2	15.6	0.46
****	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	149.1	38138	1.5	0.6	5.8	16.3	14.0	16.9	0.38
****	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1452.5	6299	1.9	1.1	3.4	20.2	17.3	13.1	0.49
***	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	183.1	3135	2.1	1.4	1.9	15.6	13.7	11.5	0.38
***	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.2	270	2.0	0.9	1.1	17.2	14.2	14.4	0.39
***	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	84.0	6031	1.8	0.7	3.5	16.0	14.7	14.3	0.38
***	Tata Large & Mid Cap	478.4	7040	1.8	0.7	-6.1	10.7	12.3	12.5	0.31
***	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	904.9	5103	1.9	1.1	6.4	15.6	11.0	11.9	0.24
***	Navi Large & Midcap	34.7	267	2.3	0.5	2.1	12.4	12.9	12.9	0.33
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	27.7	4238	1.9	0.8	12.5	21.2	16.9	-	0.37

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1955.5	91335	1.4	0.7	1.9	19.7	20.2	16.2	0.67
*****	JM Flexicap	92.1	4504	1.9	0.7	-3.7	18.8	17.5	16.2	0.46
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.7	128966	1.3	0.6	2.4	17.3	16.3	17.0	0.59
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.8	2957	1.9	0.5	4.1	18.0	15.7	14.7	0.42
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1571.3	17536	1.7	0.9	-0.8	16.9	16.0	13.5	0.45
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.0	5332	1.8	0.5	1.5	12.4	11.4	13.8	0.29
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.6	2079	2.1	1.0	2.0	14.7	13.5	13.2	0.36
****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1814.9	23018	1.7	0.9	6.1	17.9	14.3	14.2	0.39
****	Bandhan Flexi Cap	202.9	6651	1.9	1.2	2.5	15.3	13.1	11.1	0.36
****	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	329.3	11922	1.7	0.6	2.4	14.2	12.8	14.1	0.35
****	DSP Flexi Cap	99.0	10726	1.7	0.7	-0.4	15.8	12.9	14.2	0.33
****	HSBC Flexi Cap	217.1	4724	2.0	1.2	5.9	18.5	15.8	13.2	0.38
****	Kotak Flexicap	84.0	50146	1.5	0.6	4.8	15.9	13.8	13.9	0.37
****	SBI Flexicap	105.7	20626	1.7	0.9	1.1	11.7	11.4	12.2	0.31
****	Tata Flexi Cap	23.3	3310	1.9	0.6	-0.8	15.3	12.2	-	0.34
***	Axis Flexi Cap	26.0	11413	1.7	0.7	2.6	15.0	11.4	-	0.26
***	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	55.7	11679	1.7	0.8	-2.9	20.4	12.7	12.5	0.30
***	Navi Flexi Cap	23.2	232	2.2	0.5	7.6	13.3	12.7	-	0.34
***	UTI Flexi Cap	292.4	20438	1.7	1.1	-7.1	9.5	6.9	11.5	0.13
***	LIC MF Flexi Cap	94.9	895	2.4	1.7	4.8	13.1	11.1	9.9	0.27
***	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	118	2.4	0.5	-2.8	9.7	9.4	-	0.20
***	Taurus Flexi Cap	217.2	306	2.7	2.6	-0.3	13.6	11.9	9.9	0.30
-	Quant Flexi Cap	101.8	5687	1.9	0.7	6.3	18.7	19.0	19.3	0.49

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	277.4	2861	2.0	0.9	1.9	17.7	16.6	14.3	0.42
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	810.6	14681	1.8	1.0	6.4	20.8	18.3	15.0	0.54
-	Invesco India Multicap	120.6	3550	1.9	0.7	-3.1	15.9	14.5	13.4	0.36
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	35.7	5661	1.8	0.5	6.7	20.8	18.5	-	0.48
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	295.4	46321	1.5	0.7	5.6	21.2	21.8	15.7	0.64
-	Quant Multi Cap	614.1	6574	1.8	0.7	1.3	12.8	14.3	17.0	0.34
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	366.1	2525	2.0	0.9	2.3	16.3	15.7	14.7	0.42

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	102.8	13554	1.7	0.5	9.6	25.7	21.4	18.5	0.56
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	197.1	85358	1.4	0.8	9.9	24.2	22.0	18.0	0.66
*****	Quant Mid Cap	210.6	7002	1.8	0.9	-1.5	17.2	18.7	16.6	0.49
*****	Invesco India Midcap	178.9	9895	1.7	0.6	11.5	26.5	21.6	18.3	0.53
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	34.5	4099	1.9	0.5	10.2	25.0	20.9	-	0.55
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	90.9	31047	1.6	0.9	-3.1	21.7	23.7	16.4	0.57
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4318.8	39676	1.6	0.8	11.2	26.2	23.0	18.9	0.62
****	Axis Midcap	114.3	28835	1.6	0.5	9.2	20.1	16.1	16.7	0.43
****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	106.7	2129	2.0	0.5	12.1	21.8	18.3	15.8	0.49
****	ICICI Pru Midcap	325.3	6569	1.9	1.1	21.8	26.4	21.1	17.1	0.58
****	Kotak Midcap	138.2	55676	1.4	0.4	13.3	22.1	19.4	17.9	0.52
****	PGIM India Midcap	62.5	9681	1.7	0.5	3.2	14.2	14.8	15.6	0.39
****	SBI Midcap	233.6	20576	1.7	0.9	2.0	16.7	17.0	14.3	0.47
****	Sundaram Mid Cap	1412.8	11898	1.7	0.9	9.9	24.6	20.3	15.2	0.54
****	Tata Mid Cap	440.8	4993	1.9	0.7	9.2	21.6	17.8	16.3	0.49
***	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	789.8	5493	1.9	1.0	7.1	20.9	17.9	13.9	0.46
***	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2656.1	10899	1.8	1.0	1.9	20.9	16.9	14.7	0.43
***	Taurus Mid Cap	114.9	109	2.6	2.2	0.3	15.1	13.7	14.8	0.33
***	UTI Mid Cap	296.0	10482	1.8	0.9	5.9	17.5	15.4	14.2	0.39
***	DSP Midcap	147.7	17492	1.7	0.7	9.4	20.1	15.4	15.1	0.36
***	HSBC Midcap	420.8	11342	1.7	0.7	19.0	26.9	19.2	17.2	0.44
***	LIC MF Midcap	28.6	301	2.5	1.4	5.2	20.6	15.2	-	0.36

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	168.0	61809	1.4	0.7	6.1	21.2	22.9	20.7	0.56
*****	Quant Small Cap	249.7	25821	1.7	0.8	3.5	20.1	22.4	18.6	0.53
*****	AXIS Small Cap	103.9	23919	1.6	0.6	4.3	17.9	18.6	17.9	0.52

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	48.1	1770	2.0	0.5	8.9	22.0	20.8	-	0.46
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	41.6	9208	1.7	0.5	7.8	24.7	22.3	-	0.53
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	200.4	15300	1.7	0.8	14.0	21.0	20.2	16.6	0.49
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	131.0	33724	1.6	0.8	3.5	17.0	19.6	17.3	0.50
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	84.0	7538	1.8	0.8	4.0	15.9	18.6	15.8	0.53
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	248.1	15157	1.7	0.6	1.7	15.2	15.9	16.5	0.38
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	263.6	2983	2.0	0.9	10.4	20.5	19.5	14.6	0.46
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	34.4	9621	1.7	0.4	-8.5	13.1	17.9	-	0.43
★★★★	Union Small Cap	51.4	1666	2.2	1.1	16.4	20.7	19.1	15.9	0.44
★★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	167.5	11724	1.8	1.0	3.6	19.2	20.5	15.3	0.47
★★	HSBC Small Cap	78.4	13882	1.7	0.8	3.7	17.1	20.4	18.2	0.45
★★	SBI Small Cap	165.9	32286	1.6	0.8	1.1	14.0	15.7	17.6	0.42
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	87.4	4449	1.9	0.9	10.0	19.5	15.6	13.2	0.34
*	LIC MF Small Cap	30.2	552	2.4	1.1	4.9	18.8	19.1	-	0.43
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	37.1	11603	1.7	0.6	4.4	16.1	19.3	-	0.40
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	43.7	5108	1.8	0.5	5.9	19.5	19.9	-	0.59

bl rating

Scheme Name

Latest NAV (₹)

Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)

Expense Ratio (%)

Regular

Direct

Trailing Returns (%)

1 Month %Ann

3 Month %Ann

6 Month %Ann

1 Year CAGR

AA & Below

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid

2108.7

1177

0.3

0.2

8.7

6.8

6.2

6.1

-

- Aditya Birla SL Liquid

441.9

43022

0.4

0.2

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.2

-

- Axis Liquid

3054.6

30188

0.2

0.1

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.3

-

- Bandhan Liquid

3310.6

12083

0.2

0.1

9.0

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- Bank of India Liquid

3159.8

1611

0.1

0.1

8.7

6.9

6.4

6.3

-

- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid

3152.0

8599

0.3

0.1

8.8

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- Canara Robeco Liquid

3301.8

4858

0.2

0.1

9.0

7.1

6.4

6.2

-

- DSP Liquidity

3916.2

16866

0.2

0.1

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.3

-

- Edelweiss Liquid

3508.0

8877

0.1

0.0

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.3

-

- Groww Liquid

2652.3

162

0.2

0.1

8.8

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- HDFC Liquid

5380.6

53982

0.3

0.2

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.2

-

- HSBC Liquid

2733.7

13434

0.2

0.1

9.0

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- ICICI Pru Liquid

405.8

42888

0.3

0.2

8.8

6.8

6.3

6.2

-

- Invesco India Liquid

3769.3

11723

0.2

0.2

9.1

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- ITI Liquid

1426.5

58

0.3

0.1

8.5

6.6

6.0

6.1

-

- JM Liquid

74.8

2567

0.3

0.2

8.5

6.8

6.2

6.1

-

- Kotak Liquid

5541.2

33309

0.3

0.2

9.0

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- LIC MF Liquid

4957.2

11106

0.2

0.1

9.1

7.0

6.3

6.2

-

- Mahi Manu Liquid

1784.8

1012

0.3

0.2

8.7

7.0

6.3

6.3

-

- Mirae Asset Liquid

2874.8

10562

0.2

0.1

8.8

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- Motilal Oswal Liquid

14.4

1017

0.4

0.2

7.6

6.3

5.9

5.8

-

- Navi Liquid

29.7

62

0.2

0.2

6.9

5.9

5.7

5.8

-

- Nippon Ind Liquid

6692.9

25756

0.4

0.2

9.0

7.0

6.3

6.2

-

- Parag Parikh Liquid

1520.7

5171

0.2

0.1

9.1

7.0

6.3

6.1

-

- PGIM India Liquid

357.0

478

0.2

0.1

9.1

6.9

6.3

6.2

5.20

- Quant Liquid

43.2

1418

0.5

0.2

6.6

6.1

5.8

5.8

-

- Quantum Liquid

36.6

510

0.3

0.2

6.9

6.1

5.7

5.8

-

- SBI Liquid

4284.8

57891

0.3

0.2

9.1

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- Sundaram Liquid

2416.4

5175

0.4

0.1

8.9

6.8

6.2

6.1

-

- Tata Liquid

4319.7

22316

0.3

0.2

8.7

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- Union Liquid

2639.0

5756

0.2

0.1

8.8

6.9

6.3

6.2

-

- UTI Liquid

4500.5

19763

0.3

0.2

9.1

7.0

6.4

6.3

-

- WhiteOak Capital Liquid

1473.8

592

0.3

0.2

8.8

6.9

6.2

6.1

-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1449.1	4931	0.2	0.1	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Axis Overnight	1425.2	7849	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1430.0	557	0.2	0.1	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1368.6	37	0.1	0.1	5.4	5.1	5.3	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1413.0	389	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1393.6	264	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	DSP Overnight	1439.1	2255	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1392.7	127	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1404.8	527	0.1	0.1	5.3	5.1	5.3	5.4	-
-	Groww Overnight	1383.6	113	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	HDFC Overnight	3964.6	7434	0.2	0.1	5.2	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1402.3	2589	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1447.3	8824	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1360.5	316	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	ITI Overnight	1358.6	25	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.7	4.9	5.1	-
-	JM Overnight	1363.5	53	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.8	5.0	5.2	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1432.3	5067	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1389.4	902	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1389.4	27	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1377.7	708	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.4	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	144.2	3903	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1387.0	41	0.2	0.2	4.9	4.8	5.1	5.3	-
-	SBI Overnight	4334.9	17849	0.1	0.1	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1425.3	346	0.2	0.1	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.3	-
-	Tata Overnight	1415.4	2569	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Union Overnight	1412.6	398	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	UTI Overnight	3658.4	2973	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.0	5.2	5.4	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.8	25065	1.0	0.3	6.1	5.6	5.9	5.9	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9023	1.0	0.3	6.2	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.9	7790	1.1	0.3	5.7	5.5	5.6	5.6	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	45	0.9	0.4	5.2	5.2	5.7	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1276	1.1	0.3	5.5	5.3	5.5	5.7	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6376	0.9	0.3	6.1	5.6	5.8	5.8	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.3	14414	1.1	0.4	5.9	5.7	5.9	5.9	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.1	23777	0.9	0.4	6.1	5.7	6.0	5.9	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2526	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.2	6.1	6.0	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.0	31342	0.9	0.4	6.2	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.5	26370	1.1	0.4	5.9	5.7	6.0	6.0	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.6	73	0.9	0.2	4.5	5.8	6.1	6.1	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.1	353	1.1	0.4	4.5	5.2	5.6	5.5	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.3	67117	1.0	0.4	6.0	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	220	1.0	0.3	5.6	5.9	5.8	5.7	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	106	1.1	0.4	4.8	5.3	5.5	5.2	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3474	0.9	0.1	4.7	5.3	5.8	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.8	15788	1.0	0.3	5.7	5.6	5.9	5.8	0.80
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.2	100	1.0	0.4	5.5	5.5	5.6	5.4	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.5	41059	0.9	0.4	5.8	5.7	5.9	6.0	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	412	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.0	6.0	5.8	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.1	20686	1.1	0.3	6.0	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.7	241	1.0	0.4	5.4	5.6	5.7	5.6	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.8	10500	0.8	0.3	6.2	5.8	6.0	6.0	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year	2 Year	3 Year	5 Year	
						CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Savings	576.6	19348	0.6	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	8.68
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1620.6	705	0.5	0.3	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.2	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4228.4	9512	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.8	6.8	6.7	24.37
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	3528	0.5	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.1	13619	0.8	0.4	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.1	11.70
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1375.1	1640	0.4	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.2	1.22
★★★★	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4439.4	3130	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.3	8.56
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	3958	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.6	10.59
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short	3567.6	3560	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.6	8.42
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16037	0.7	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	4.28
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1422.5	2470	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2829.0	963	0.8	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.8	12.87
★★★★	Kotak Savings	45.0	14989	0.8	0.4	6.1	6.7	6.8	5.9	7.59
★★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1443.8	194	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.87
★★★★	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6274.7	11847	0.6	0.4	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.0	9.47
★★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1424.2	586	1.0	0.5	5.8	6.4	6.5	5.6	-
★★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3312.2	117	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.6	9.44
★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1382.5	187	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.5	2.88
★★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	161	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.6	-
★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	3955	1.2	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.6	8.31
★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3976.2	483	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.5	5.4	-
★★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	411	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.6	5.7	4.8	-
★★	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2797.3	1454	1.4	0.2	5.2	5.9	6.0	5.1	2.13
DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Savings	572.1	26665	0.6	0.4	6.5	7.4	7.5	6.5	6.87

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★★★★★	UTI Low Duration	3727.0	2246	0.4	0.3	6.3	7.3	7.2	7.3	7.56
★★★★★	Axis Treasury Advantage	3248.7	5455	0.7	0.3	6.3	7.2	7.2	6.2	8.20
★★★★★	DSP Low Duration	20.8	4669	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★★★	HDFC Low Duration	60.5	22104	1.1	0.5	6.0	6.9	7.0	6.0	12.55
★★★★★	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	981	0.9	0.4	7.4	7.6	7.5	6.2	9.83
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	686.0	10865	1.2	0.4	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.8	12.11
★★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.4	5723	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	44.2	1295	0.5	0.2	6.1	7.0	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	3965.3	1659	0.7	0.3	6.1	7.0	7.0	5.9	6.15
★★★★	JM Low Duration	38.8	212	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.9	6.8	5.8	5.86
★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3921.1	8768	1.1	0.4	6.0	6.9	6.9	6.0	8.84
★★★★	SBI Low Duration	3652.5	13583	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.8	3.90
★★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4119.2	2460	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.9	6.9	6.0	3.03
★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3496.8	15257	1.2	0.4	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.8	12.08
★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1710.1	255	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.7	5.7	13.73
★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2363.7	2333	0.8	0.2	5.9	6.8	6.8	5.7	3.96
★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3610.1	436	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.6	6.6	5.7	2.98
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.9	260	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.6	5.6	1.94
★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1830	0.4	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.6	5.6	2.85
DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4366.2	19420	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3245.6	18344	0.2	0.1	6.5	7.3	7.4	6.4	-
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	389.3	2839	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★★	Axis Money Market	1506.2	20349	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.3	7.3	6.3	-
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	399.3	31050	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4724.8	32331	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1449.7	4365	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.0	5.9	-
★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.8	3959	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
★★★	HDFC Money Market	6013.8	28189	0.5	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
★★★	PGIM India Money Market	1393.0	152	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★	Sundaram Money Market	15.8	1943	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.1	6.1	-
★★★	Tata Money Market	4969.0	32382	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.4	-
★★	DSP Savings	55.3	8947	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★	HSBC Money Market	27.7	5970	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.1	5.9	-
★★	Invesco India Money Market	3199.5	7154	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★	SBI Savings	43.5	34892	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	42.4	13437	0.4	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.0	5.8	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.8	2508	0.8	0.1	5.9	6.6	6.6	5.5	-
DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	62.9	20688	1.1	0.5	5.6	7.4	7.3	6.4	10.50
★★★★★	UTI Short Term	33.0	2359	0.8	0.4	4.9	6.9	7.0	6.9	14.38
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.6	6501	1.0	0.4	5.1	7.2	7.0	6.2	9.43
★★★★★	Axis Short Duration	32.3	8342	0.9	0.4	5.5	7.5	7.2	6.1	9.59
★★★★★	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.4	14728	0.7	0.4	5.3	7.4	7.3	6.2	9.99
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Short Duration	55.0	6632	1.0	0.4	5.2	7.3	7.1	6.0	8.51
★★★★	Bandhan Short Duration	59.6	8612	0.8	0.3	5.2	7.3	7.0	5.8	-
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.3	280	1.1	0.4	4.8	7.0	6.8	5.7	1.80
★★★★	HSBC Short Duration	27.5	3799	0.7	0.3	5.0	7.1	6.8	5.6	-
★★★★	Kotak Bond Short Term	54.1	15582	1.1	0.4	4.6	6.9	6.7	5.7	-
★★★★	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	593	1.1	0.2	4.2	6.7	6.5	5.5	-
★★★★	SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	14580	0.9	0.4	5.0	7.1	6.9	5.9	6.58
★★★★	Sundaram Short Duration	46.1	1900	0.7	0.3	5.0	7.1	6.9	5.9	2.62
★★	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.4	357	1.0	0.3	4.7	6.6	6.4	5.3	-
★★	DSP Short Short	48.3	2903	0.9	0.4	4.5	6.8	6.6	5.5	-
★★	Invesco India Short Duration	3697.5	712	1.1	0.4	4.7	6.8	6.7	5.4	3.91
★★	Tata Short Term Bond	49.5	2785	1.2	0.3	4.1	6.5	6.4	5.4	-
★	Kotak Short Term	2159.3	88	1.1	0.4	4.8	6.6	6.1	4.9	-
★	LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	188	1.2	0.4	4.4	6.7	6.4	5.1	5.69
-	Bank of India Short Term Income	27.8	278	1.0	0.5	4.7	7.6	6.9	10.1	2.89
-	Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.2	848	1.3	0.4	4.8	6.9	6.7	5.6	13.56
DEBT - MEDIUM DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium Duration	16.4	143	1.0	0.5	7.0	8.5	7.6	8.9	36.90
★★★★★	Axis Strategic Bond	29.3	2083	1.3	0.7	5.5	7.8	7.5	6.6	55.06
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium Term Bond	47.2	5524	1.4	0.7	6.4	8.1	7.6	6.7	36.08
★★★★	HDFC Medium Term Debt	58.7	3592	1.3	0.7	5.0	7.4	7.1	6.1	33.76
★★★★	Kotak Medium Term	23.8	1807	1.6	0.7	6.1	7.9	7.6	6.4	44.81
★★★★	SBI Medium Duration	53.3	6580	1.2	0.7	4.8	7.2	7.1	6.2	46.83
★★★	DSP Bond	84.7	304	0.8	0.4	4.3	7.0	6.9	5.8	-
★★★	HSBC Medium Duration	21.2	737	1.1	0.4	4.7	7.3	7.1	6.0	31.74
★★	Bandhan Medium Duration	47.2	1329	1.4	0.7	3.9	6.7	6.3	5.1	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Medium Term	42.6	3078	1.6	0.8	8.2	11.3	9.6	11.9	42.48
-	Sundaram Medium Duration	70.5	34	2.1	1.1	2.5	5.3	5.0	4.0	2.94
-	UTI Medium Duration	18.8	37	1.4	0.8	3.6	6.4	6.3	6.0	24.65
DEBT - MEDIUM TO LONG DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium to Long Duration	41.6	300	1.6	1.2	2.4	6.1	5.9	5.8	5.01
★★★★★	UTI Bond	71.2	2698	1.1	0.6	2.4	6.8	6.8	5.8	-
★★★★★	SBI Medium to Long Duration	72.1	2034	1.5	0.8	2.1	6.2	6.2	5.6	34.10
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Income	126.9	1792	1.7	0.8	5.8	5.7	5.7	5.3	-
★★★★	Kotak Bond	77.8	1878	1.7	0.7	1.3	5.8	5.9	5.2	-
★★★★	LIC MF Medium to Long Duration	73.8	189	0.5	0.2	2.2	5.6	5.4	5.3	-
★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium to Long Dur	90.8	368	1.5	0.7	0.9	6.6	5.8	5.1	-
★★★	Bandhan Medium to Long Duration	66.2	451	2.0	1.3	1.7	5.6	5.4	4.4	-
★★	HDFC Income	59.0	820	1.4	0.8	1.0	6.0	6.0	4.8	-
★	Canara Robeco Income	55.9	114	1.9	0.8	0.7	5.1	5.0	4.2	-
-	HSBC Medium to Long Duration	42.8	49	1.2	0.7	1.4	5.8	5.5	4.5	-
-	JM Medium to Long Duration	63.3	30	1.1	0.6	2.0	6.4	6.1	4.9	-
DEBT - LONG DURATION FUNDS										
-	ICICI Pru Long Term Bond	89.8	897	1.0	0.4	-1.1	5.6	5.9	4.8	-
-	Nippon Ind Nivesh Lakshya LD	17.7	7538	0.7	0.3	-2.0	5.2	5.8	5.1	-
DEBT - DYNAMIC BOND FUNDS										
★★★★★	360 ONE Dynamic Bond	32.5	495	0.5	0.3	4.7	7.8	7.6	6.7	4.21
★★★★★	UTI Dynamic Bond	31.9	518	1.6	0.7	3.1	6.7	6.6	8.6	-
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dynamic Bond	47.8	1510	1.2	0.6	3.1	7.4	7.0	6.6	37.63
★★★★★	ICICI Pru All Seasons Bond	28.8	14002	1.3	0.6	3.7	7.1	7.0	6.3	22.17
★★★★★	Quantum Dynamic Bond	31.2	91	1.0	0.5	1.2	6.4	6.6	5.9	-
★★★★★	Axis Dynamic Bond	30.7	1073	0.6	0.3	3.3	7.1	6.9	5.8	-
★★★★	DSP Strategic Bond	3368.3	789	1.2	0.5	-1.4	5.3	6.1	5.2	-
★★★★	HDFC Dynamic Debt	90.7	598	1.4	0.8	0.6	5.7	5.9	6.0	-
★★★★	Kotak Dynamic Bond	38.4	2465	1.3	0.6	2.0	6.6	6.7	5.7	9.89
★★★★	Nippon Ind Dynamic Bond	38.4	3976	0.8	0.4	3.4	7.2	6.9	5.8	-
★★★★	PGIM India Dynamic Bond	2661.3	86	1.7	0.5	0.4	5.8	5.9	4.9	-
★★★	SBI Dynamic Bond	36.8	3928	1.3	0.6	2.4	6.8	6.7	5.8	-
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Dynamic Bond	45.7	134	1.7	0.7	-0.9	5.1	5.4	4.8	-

Economist Ashok Lahiri is new NITI Vice-Chair; 4 new members named

TOP REJIG. Lahiri, an ex-CEA and outgoing MLA in the West Bengal Assembly, will replace Suman Berry

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has reconstituted NITI (National Institution of Transforming India) with the appointment of noted economist, Ashok Lahiri as Vice-Chairman, and four new full-time members. Former Cabinet Secretary Rajiv Gauba has been retained as a full-time member.

Prime Minister is the ex officio chairman of NITI.

“His rich experience in economics and public policy will greatly strengthen India’s reform journey and the journey towards becoming a Viksit Bharat. I am confident his efforts will further energise policy-making in our nation,” Modi said in a social media post while announcing the reconstitution.

Further, he said the NITI Aayog has emerged as a vital pillar in India’s policy-making architecture, fostering cooperative federalism,



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Ashok Lahiri, who has been appointed Vice-Chairman of National Institution of Transforming India

furthering reforms and boosting ‘Ease of Living’. It serves as a dynamic platform for innovation and long-term strategic thinking across sectors.

Lahiri will replace Suman Berry and his appointment will be valid from the date of assumption of charge until further orders. There is no fixed term for the Vice-Chairman. Lahiri is an outgoing MLA in the West Bengal Assembly. Elected on a BJP ticket, he represented the

Balurghat (Dakshin Dinajpur) constituency.

KEY ASSIGNMENTS

Lahiri, a well-known economist, served as a member of the 15th Finance Commission. Earlier, he was the 12th Chief Economic Advisor to the Government of India. He has had stints with the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund (IMF), as a Consultant and Senior Economist, respectively.

Apart from Lahiri, four new members include K V Raju, Gobardhan Das, Abhay Karandikar and M Srinivas.

FOUR NEW MEMBERS

Raju is currently part-time Member of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. He is also Economic Advisor to the UP government.

Das is the Director of the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Bhopal.

Karandikar is currently Secretary, Department of Science and Technology (DST).

Srinivas is the Director of AIIMS. He joined AIIMS in 1994 and became Professor of Paediatric Surgery in 2011. His administrative experience includes development of new medical colleges under the ESI Corporation and has contributed to initiation of more than 10 new medical colleges and started post-graduate and super-specialty courses in these institutes.

India Cements Q4 net up four times at ₹59 crore on better realisation

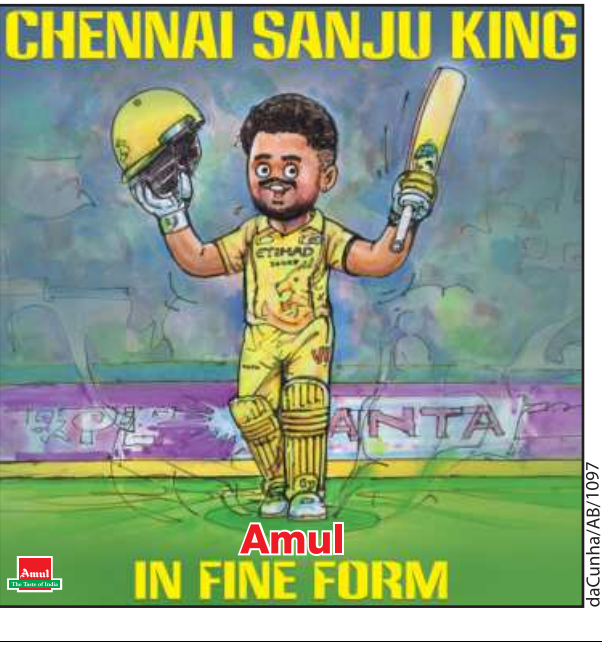
Our Bureau
Mumbai

India Cements, now a subsidiary of UltraTech Cement, reported a quadrupling of its net profit in the March quarter to ₹59 crore against ₹15 crore in the same period last year largely on better realisation and lower cost.

Revenue was up 3 per cent at ₹1,229 crore (₹1,198 crore) and EBITDA increased to ₹179 crore (₹23 crore). Operating EBITDA rose to ₹497/tonne against ₹305 in Q3.

Expenses were down 11 per cent at ₹1,175 crore (₹1,313 crore) with power and freight costs falling to ₹466 crore (₹475 crore) and ₹35 crore (₹243 crore), respectively.

Q4 sales were up 18 per cent at 3.12 million tonnes with completion of brand migration in the quarter.



Gold, silver exporters to get higher refunds on hike in duty drawback rates

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Exporters of gold and silver jewellery will now get higher refunds under the Drawback Rules. The Finance Ministry has notified a quarterly review of All India Rates of Duty Drawback for gold jewellery and silver jewellery/articles.

Accordingly, the new rate under tariff item 711301 (pertaining to articles of jewellery and parts, made of gold) will be ₹773.17 per gram of net gold content in the jewellery as against ₹639.59. For tariff item 711302 (pertaining to articles of jewellery and parts thereof, made of silver including plated with precious metal), the rate would be ₹14,990.66 per kg of net silver content in the jewellery as against ₹9089.33. This rate will also be applicable for tariff item 711401 (articles made of silver, other than jewellery).

OFFERS RELIEF

Duty drawback serves as a refund mechanism that reimburses exporters for Customs and excise duties paid on imported inputs used in manufacturing export goods. It is a World Trade Organization-vetted scheme administered by the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs to promote exports. It rebates the incidence of Customs and excise duties, chargeable on imported and excisable materials respectively, when used as inputs for goods to be exported.

The revision in duty draw-



back rates aims to provide relief to Indian gems and jewellery exporters, who are facing higher input costs and subdued demand. The move is expected to partially offset the impact of these developments and help exporters stay competitive internationally. Also, the hike in the duty may aid exporters to see improved refund inflows, revise export prices and renegotiate contracts

Gold and silver prices are seeing high volatility after a very sharp increase in recent times. On Friday, the yellow metal prices were up by ₹420 at ₹1,51,479 per 10 gram against ₹1,51,059 on Thursday. In fact, the precious metal opened weak by ₹395 at ₹1,50,664 but gained ground on a weak rupee. At the same time, silver prices plunged ₹2,577 to ₹2.38 lakh per kg in the national capital on Friday, tracking weak trends and subdued demand by investors. On the Multi Commodity Exchange, the white metal for May delivery depreciated by ₹2,577, or 1.07 per cent, to ₹2,38,936 per kg.

Experts said that gold prices in domestic market are driven largely by West Asia developments. With conflicting signals and no resolution in sight, gold is expected to stay news-driven and volatile, they added.

Mastek to sell Mahindra World City building to Caresoft for ₹60 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Mastek Ltd plans to sell its commercial building at Mahindra World City SEZ at Chengalpattu, near Chennai, to Caresoft Mobility Pvt Ltd

for ₹60 crore. The IT company on Friday night said it has entered into an MoU for selling the commercial building with an approximate built-up area of 1,57,233 sq ft on 15.50 acres of leased land at Mahindra World City.

Axis Bank Q4 net dips a tad on lower other income, one-time provision

Scorecard

Axis bank	Q4FY26 ₹ cr	Q4FY25 ₹ cr	% change
Net profit	7,071.31	7,117.5	-0.65
Net interest Income	14,457.18	13,810.54	4.68
Other income	6,022.55	6,779.52	-11.165
Operating profit	10,013.42	10,752.37	-6.87
Total provisions and contingencies (other than tax)	3,522.21	1,359.35	159.11
Tax expense	-580.10	2,275.52	
GNPAs %	1.23	1.28	
NNPAs %	0.37	0.33	
Deposits	13,35,833.97	11,72,952.02	13.89
CASA deposits %	40.00	41.00	
Advances	12,33,569.88	10,40,811.32	18.52

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Axis Bank reported a marginal decline in fourth quarter standalone net profit at ₹7,071 crore against ₹7,117.50 crore in the year ago quarter, with a decline in other income and an additional one-time provision weighing on the bottom line.

For FY26, the net profit was down 7 per cent at ₹24,457 crore (₹26,373 crore in FY25).

The board of directors of India’s third largest private sector bank recommended a final dividend of ₹1 per equity share (face value of ₹2 each) for FY26.

The board also approved raising of funds by issuance of debt instruments in Indian/foreign currency up to ₹35,000 crore. It also approved raising of funds by issuance of equity shares/depository receipts aggregating to ₹20,000 crore.

The bank’s overall net interest margin declined to 3.62 per cent from 3.97 per cent in

the year ago quarter.

However, in view of the macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties, the bank created an additional one-time provision of ₹2,001 crore.

Referring to the additional one-time provision, Puneet Sharma, CFO, said that the move is prudent and precautionary in nature and does not reflect any deterioration in asset quality or adverse credit trends in the bank’s loan or investment portfolio as of reporting date. Sharma said the bank’s adverse test scenario assumes average oil prices over \$150/barrel for 12 months, inflation at 7.4 per cent and currency depreciating by 20 per cent over current levels.

Amitabh Chaudhry, MD & CEO, said: “There is nothing in our portfolio which tells us that these (additional one-time) provisions will be used. It is not based on what we see today, but the whole scenario in West Asia remains uncertain.

Kavitha floats Telangana Rashtra Sena, says father KCR a different man now

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad



(file photo) Kalvakuntla Kavitha

Kalvakuntla Kavitha, daughter of K Chandrasekhara Rao, President of the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) and former Chief Minister of Telangana, on Saturday launched a new political outfit — the Telangana Rashtra Sena (TRS).

Announcing the formation of the party at a public meeting in Medchal near Hyderabad, Kavitha said the aspirations that had fuelled the Telangana movement remained unfulfilled even after the formation of the State.

“The dream that drove the Telangana movement has not been realised even after the formation of the State. The BRS failed to understand the aspirations of the people of Telangana.

The chariot of the Telangana movement lost its way under KCR’s leadership,” she said.

POLITICAL HISTORY

Kavitha, who was a key face of the BRS during its rule from 2014 to 2024, said she, too, had been a part of

Montra Electric expands small-truck range with two new variants

Our Bureau
Chennai

Montra Electric, the clean mobility brand of the Chennai-based Murugappa Group, has expanded its eSCV portfolio with the introduction of two new EVIATOR variants, EVIATOR 350 (32kWh) and EVIATOR 350L+ (50kWh).

While the 40kWh EVIATOR remains a core pillar of the lineup, the new 32kWh variant is engineered as the ‘last-mile champion’ for high efficiency runs up to 140 km, providing a more accessible price point without compromising on the brand’s signature 99 per cent uptime.

Conversely, the EVIATOR 350 L+

(50kWh) variant is positioned as the ‘Marathon Runner’, offering a category-leading certified range of 300+ km and a real-world range of 200+ km to eliminate anxiety for inter-city logistics and power-hungry specialised applications like reefer and municipal services, a company release said.

With this expansion, Montra Electric is moving beyond a one-size-fits-all approach to electric mobility and introducing a duty-cycle and use-case led vehicle strategy, where fleet operators can choose battery configurations aligned to their exact operational needs, from high-frequency urban routes to intensive inter-city logistics, the release said.

Jalaj Gupta, Managing Director, Montra Electric, said, “The next

phase of EV adoption will not be driven by products alone, but by how intelligently they fit into real-world operations. This is a critical step in making electric mobility not just viable but scalable for commercial applications, enhancing operational efficiency while significantly reducing logistics costs.”

With three distinct battery configurations (32kWh, 40kWh and 50kWh), EVIATOR becomes the only electric SCV platform designed around application-specific energy needs, setting a new benchmark for flexibility and operational precision.

The EVIATOR range is priced at an introductory ₹14.58 lakh for the 32 kWh variant and ₹16.86 lakh for the 50 kWh variant.

RBI clears B Ramesh Babu for 3rd term as MD and CEO of Karur Vysya Bank



Our Bureau
Chennai

The Reserve Bank of India has approved the appointment of B Ramesh Babu as MD and CEO of Karur Vysya Bank for a third term of two years. This will be effective from July 29, 2026. The RBI approved Babu’s re-appointment on April 24, the bank said in an announcement to the stock exchanges.

businessline.

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Axis Finance raises ₹750 crore from Kedaara Capital via preferential issue

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Axis Finance Ltd (AFL), the wholly-owned non-banking financial company (NBFC) subsidiary of Axis Bank, on Saturday announced a ₹750 crore primary capital raise from Kedaara Capital via a preferential issuance. This is in addition to the ₹1,500 crore primary raise via a

rights issue approved by Axis Finance board on April 17.

AFL’s assets under finance, comprising retail, wholesale, MSME and treasury, rose 22 per cent yoy to ₹47,692 crore as at March-end 2026. The NBFC reported a net profit of ₹806 crore, up 19 per cent yoy in FY26. Its total Capital Adequacy Ratio was 19.65 per cent as at March-end.

Pine Labs buys checkout platform Shopflo for ₹88 cr

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Fintech major Pine Labs has acquired a 100 per cent stake in checkout optimisation start-up Shopflo Technologies for up to ₹88 crore in cash, as it looks to strengthen its online payments and unified commerce offerings, according to a regulatory filing and company statement. The acquisition, approved by the Pine Labs board on Saturday, is expected to be completed within three month, and will

see the company buy out existing shareholders of Shopflo. Shopflo, incorporated in December 2021, reported revenue of ₹14.735 crore for the year ended March 2025, reflecting rapid growth from ₹0.633 crore in FY23. “Commerce today is no longer defined by channels — merchants need a single, intelligent platform that can power both their offline and online journeys,” said B Amrish Rau, CEO of Pine Labs. “We are taking a decisive step toward building a truly full-stack payments and commerce platform.”

सी पी सी एल CPCL Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (A Government of India Enterprise and a group company of IndianOil) Regd. Office: 536, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai - 600 018 Website: www.cpcl.co.in; Email id: shankarp@cpcl.co.in Tel: 044-24349833 / 24346807 CIN - L40101TN1965GOI005389											
EXTRACT OF THE STATEMENT OF AUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026											
(₹ in crore)											
Sl. No.	Particulars	STANDALONE					CONSOLIDATED				
		QUARTER ENDED		YEAR ENDED			THREE MONTHS ENDED		YEAR ENDED		
		31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025
		Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
1	Total income from operations	20476.14	19467.40	20592.98	78705.24	71093.43	20476.14	19467.40	20593.00	78676.14	71075.19
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	1890.40	1317.03	581.71	4121.62	208.10	1912.55	1331.40	601.68	4162.47	248.66
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	1890.40	1317.03	581.71	4121.62	208.10	1912.55	1331.40	601.68	4162.47	248.66
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	1399.70	987.22	449.96	3061.85	173.53	1421.85	1001.59	469.93	3102.70	214.09
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	1374.30	991.13	447.25	3055.11	164.55	1396.64	1005.50	466.85	3096.15	204.74
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face Value - ₹ 10 each)	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91	148.91
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)				10401.07	7539.55				10710.26	7807.70
8	Securities Premium Account				250.04	250.04				250.04	250.04
9	Networth				10800.02	7938.50				11109.21	8206.85
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt (Bonds / Debentures) excluding Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares				-	810.00				-	810.00
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares (2025: Nil (2024:50.00,00.00) Non-Convertible) Cumulative Redeemable Preference Shares of ₹ 10 each (Not listed)				-	500.00				-	500.00
12	Debt Equity Ratio				0.18	0.39				0.18	0.38
13	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)										
	(i) Basic (₹ / share)	94.00	66.30	30.22	205.62	11.65	95.48	67.26	31.56	208.36	14.38
	(ii) Diluted (₹ / share)	94.00	66.30	30.22	205.62	11.65	95.48	67.26	31.56	208.36	14.38
Note:											
1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites: www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com. The same is also available on the company's website www.cpcl.co.in											
2 For the other items of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to stock exchanges (BSE and NSE) and can be accessed on www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com											
BY ORDER OF THE BOARD											
Place : Chennai Date : April 24, 2026											
Rohit Kumar Agrawala Director (Finance) DIN: 10048961											